

FINAL REPORT

Fifteenth Annual Meeting
of the
General Service Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous

Roosevelt Hotel, New York City

April 19-24, 1965



*Individual A. A. members may order copies of this report,
through their G. S. R. or other Group officers*

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Fifteenth Annual Meeting General Service Conference of A.A.

CONTENTS

1965 Conference At A Glance

Summary of Actions Taken	4
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The Sense of the Conference

Search for More Effective Ways to Use Tools of Service	5
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General: Special Presentations & Discussions

Structuring General Service Board, Dr. Norris.....	6
'Our Great Responsibility,' By Bill	8
'What Happened to Those Who Left?' By Bill	10
'On Being Responsible,' Dr. Norris.....	10
'A Million Dividends,' John Murtagh.....	10
Strengthening Conference Committees	11
30th International Convention	11
The Influence of the Conference	12
Attracting More A.A.'s to Service Opportunities.....	13
Importance of Beginner A.A. Programs.....	13
Conference Attendance by Ex-Delegates Rejected	13
Five New Trustees on Service Board.....	14
Grapevine Presentation	14
A.A. Family Groups Discussed.....	14
A.A. and Al-Anon Cooperation.....	15
Monthly Sharing Plan Extended.....	15
Third Year Term Rejected.....	15
International Young People's Convention	16
Step Toward Pension Program.....	16
'Anonymity Attractive Force'.....	16
Interview Time	17
Area Report Highlights	17
'Area Delegates Only' Meeting	18
Vital Communications (P.I.C.)	18
A.A. in Colombia and San Salvador.....	19

Questions and Answers

Topics from Ask-It Basket	20
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Color Film: Bill and Lois

General Service Office Reports

A.A. World Services, Inc./G.S.O.	23
International Committee	24
G.S.O. Information Activities.....	24
G.S.B. Public Information Committee	24
G.S.B. Policy Committee.....	24
A.A. Overseas	25
English-speaking and Far East	25
A.A. in Institutions.....	26
Conference Secretary's Report	26

Tape Service	26
The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	26
The 'A.A. Exchange Bulletin'	26
Lone Members	26
Internationalists	26
Nominating Committee of G.S.B.	27
Service Material.....	27
Coordinator's Report	27
Observers' Reports.....	28
Trustees Report	29
Literature Report	29
Spanish-speaking Groups.....	29
Efficient G.S.O. Growth.....	29

Conference Advisory Actions

Committee on Other Agencies	30
Committee on Convention	30
Committee on Policy	30
Committee on Report, Charter	30
Committee on Literature.....	31
Committee on Grapevine	31
Committee on Finance	31
Committee on Agenda	32
Committee on Admissions	32
Committee on Trustees.....	32

Financial Data

1965 G.S.O. Budget.....	32
Growth and Money at G.S.O.	33
Combined Balance Sheet	34
G.S.O. Income Statement	35
Grapevine Income Statement.....	36
1965 Grapevine Budget.....	36
G.S.B. Finance and Budgetary Committee.....	37
Suggested Share of 1965 Budget	37
1964 Group Contributions	38

Rosters

Non-Area Conference Members	39
Trustees of General Service Board (Biographies).....	40
General Service Board Committees.....	41
1965 Conference Area Delegates	42
1965 Conference Committees	44

Miscellaneous

Dates of Trustees Meetings	7
Digest of 1965 Conference	28
Bill's Statement on His Finances	7

CONFERENCE AT A GLANCE

'Responsibility To Those We Serve' Keynotes Meeting

Goal: To 'Carry Message' More Effectively

Delegates to the Fifteenth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous spent six active days evaluating the important contributions of the Conference to the growth of the Fellowship to date — and its potential for increasingly constructive service in the future.

From Monday, April 19, through Saturday, April 24, 87 Area Delegates and 36 General Service Office personnel and Trustees shared their "experience, hope and strength" to strengthen the Fellowship's Third Legacy of World Service.

Among many constructive decisions and "Advisory Actions," the Conference:

Reaffirmed the growing value of committee work in conduct of the Conference and took major steps to make it more effective and productive. All Delegates will be appointed to committees and more time in and between Conferences is to be devoted to committee functions.

Recommended the use of the "Early Bird" edition of the Conference Digest as an aid to Delegates in the preparation of reports in their Areas immediately following the Conference.

Recommended that the General Service Representative be the Group recipient of material mailed to Groups from the General Service Office.

Reaffirmed the value of retaining the two-year term of office for General Service Conference Delegates.

Reaffirmed the basic A.A. principle of rotation in service positions and disapproved a proposal that former Delegates be permitted to attend Conference Meetings as Observers.

TRUSTEES

Received, for study in the Areas during the coming year, a unanimous proposal of the Trustees (two abstaining) for structuring the General Service Board, with the understanding that Delegates to the 1966 Conference will vote on the proposals next April.

THE FELLOWSHIP OF A.A.

Based on reports to G.S.O., Spring 1965

	Groups	Members
United States.....	7,543	128,498
Canada.....	1,146	15,928
Overseas.....	1,854	36,846
In Hospitals.....	570	10,764
In Prisons.....	648	25,000
Internationalists.....	—	332
Lone Members....	—	(599)*
Totals	11,752	217,967

(Including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at more than 350,000.)

**These members included in Area totals.*

Nominated, using Third Legacy procedures, R. Fay Brown of North Dakota to be the Regional A.A. Trustee from the West Central Region, Frank Russell of Massachusetts to be the Regional A.A. Trustee from the Northeast Region, and Tom Breen of Manitoba to be the A.A. Trustee from Canada.

Approved the nomination of Vincent Dole, M.D., of New York City to fill the non-alcoholic trusteeship vacancy created by the resignation of Ivan Underwood of Rye, N.Y.

Reaffirmed earlier (by mail) approval of the election of Dr. Travis Dancey of Montreal as the first Class A (non-alcoholic) Trustee from Canada.

FINANCES

Approved plans for extending the Monthly Sharing Plan to all U.S. and Canadian Groups, following analysis of the successful results obtained in test Areas during the past year.

Recommended that the pattern of book discount waivers (whereby Groups have waived a portion of their discount to permit creation of an adequate Reserve Fund) be continued but that the Reserve Fund, now in excess of \$300,000, receive no further funds from book discounts waived. In this connection, it was further recommended that, effective in 1965, funds available from book discounts waived be used to develop a pension or retirement plan for employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

A.A. GRAPEVINE

Recommended that the A.A. Grapevine use the services of Area Committees to develop Group and individual subscriptions.

Constructive Growth of A.A. Stressed

OTHER AGENCIES

Reaffirmed the A.A. Tradition that the Fellowship, in fact and in name, should not be identified with the operation of hospitals, rest homes and other community rehabilitation facilities.

ADMISSIONS

Recommended, on the basis of population, growth and communications needs, that an additional Delegate from the State of Indiana be admitted to the Conference in 1966.

LITERATURE

Approved preparation of new pamphlets on the functions of General Service Representatives and on "A.A. and the Community."

Approved preliminary drafts of pamphlets on "A.A. in Hospitals" and on "The A.A. Group."

Approved a suggestion that the new guide for conducting "Newcomers Meetings" be used in its present form as service material, with the addition of the A.A. preamble and the A.A. slogans.

Rejected a proposal for a pamphlet on "slippees" in the belief that it would not "serve our primary purpose."

TORONTO CONVENTION

Approved plans for the preparation of a book entitled "A.A./30" to be distributed at the Thirtieth Anniversary International Convention, July 2-4.

Heard with enthusiasm that advance registrations for the Toronto Convention already exceed 6,000.

FAMILY GROUPS

Expressed an opinion that non-A.A.s should not hold office in regular A.A. Groups and that Groups which include non-A.A.s as regular members should not carry "A.A." in their name. (It was emphasized that these recommendations do not apply to regular A.A. Groups that welcome non-A.A.s at open meetings.)

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

A Search for More Effective Ways to Use Tools of Service

Delegates to the Fifteenth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous assembled at a unique moment in A.A. history. Looking forward to the celebration of the Fellowship's 30th birthday, they were able to see half of the movement's history reflected in earlier pages of the Conference's own story. Appraising the growth already achieved, and the clear potential for future growth, they might have been tempted to forget that all growth requires consistent nourishment. And being human in a period of unprecedented material prosperity in most parts of the world, they could well have lost sight of the deep spiritual basis that is the true core of the A.A. program.

It would have been easy, at a time when the Fellowship seems more united and more effective than ever before, to be a "do nothing" Conference. It would have been simple to accept a passive role, to assume that the tools of A.A. world service require no further analysis or testing. And the Delegates could have regarded the Conference itself as a tool to be admired rather than put to work as a living organism.

But this was a constructive Conference in the finest sense of the term. Where it could have been passive, it was active. This was a Conference that, more than any preceding Conferences, took its individual problems, viewpoints and questions into small meetings where they could be talked out, thought out and, usually, worked out, before being brought before the Conference as a whole.

Improving Conference Committees

The enthusiasm with which the Delegates tackled the problem of making Conference Committees more effective was typically revealing. It reflected the extensive experience of men and women who had learned much from service work in their own Areas. They were looking for information and service material, as well as for inspiration. They were seeking techniques for saving time -- their own and that of all other Delegates.

To this end, Delegates made good use of Committee "workshops" to set new dimensions for Conference Committees -- in terms of size and chairmanship of committees, in terms of meetings and year-'round work opportunities.

'Interview Time' Proves Time Saver

"Interview Time" served a somewhat similar purpose -- to improve communications between Delegates and between Delegates and the General Service Office. This new feature of the agenda proved both practical and popular, as a time saver for the Conference generally, as an opportunity for close contact between Delegates and Staff.

Delegates, too, were budget conscious -- more fully aware that all A.A. monies require special stewardship. They were eager not only to proclaim their own experience but to record that of

other A.A.'s. And they were consistently realistic in evaluating the progress of A.A. in their own Areas and throughout the world.

The Fifteenth Conference was the first to be asked formally to consider the influence of the Conference structure on various segments of the Fellowship. It was certainly not unexpected that all who voiced an opinion -- Trustees, G.S.O. Staff Members and Delegates -- asserted that the Conference had, indeed, had a beneficial influence on the development of A.A. during the past decade and a half. But other opinions were equally impressive. One was the suggestion that Delegates -- some of them, at least -- do not fully appreciate their potential, as the voice of the collective conscience of A.A., to influence the future constructive growth of the Fellowship. Another thought-provoking comment, by a former Delegate who is now a Trustee, reminded the Conference that the General Service Board, the General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine want to be influenced by Delegates, want to know their honest opinions, want their best estimates of opinion in their Areas.

Paradox of Growth and Simplicity

Since its first services to alcoholics began to develop nearly 30 years ago, A.A. has been confronted with a paradox whose power to divide the movement can never be discounted. It is the paradox posed by the growing complexity of a worldwide movement on the one hand, and on the other; the inherent desire of nearly all members to keep the A.A. structure as simple as possible. In a Fellowship as loosely organized as A.A., there has always been room for both the enthusiasts who welcome new structural complexities and for those who retreat in horror from any project more complicated than a Twelfth Step call.

The basic problem has been to make enthusiasm truly effective and productive, and not merely to give it a home in a new committee. At the other extreme, there has been the problem of demonstrating, to those who intone "Keep It Simple," that the proper use of the structure and apparatus of modern communications is, almost invariably, the simplest way to carry the A.A. message to the millions who may want help with a drinking problem.

In essence, the most constructive achievement of the Fifteenth Conference was its refurbishing of the tools of world service that are available within the Conference. By examining them carefully, and by making them work effectively, Delegates clarified and simplified many of the objectives and procedures of the Conference. More efficient committee sessions, less time wasted on minor matters at full Conference sessions, greater sharing of movement-wide experience during special meetings with Staff Members, improved delegation of responsibility for committee functions -- all these are accomplishments that can be credited to the 1965 Conference.

And the successful search for more effective ways to use the tools of world service leaves a heritage that should make all future Conferences more meaningful and more productive.

STRUCTURING THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

John L. Norris, M.D.
Chairman, General Service Board

As the Fellowship moves into its 30th year and the Board into its 27th, we have undertaken to assess the present Board structure and to make specific recommendations for the Board's foreseeable future. We realize that no actions taken by the Trustees or by the Conference are forever binding. In fact, it will prove desirable in the future to review Board structure at regular intervals and make whatever changes new experience or changing circumstances make necessary.

The Board believes that we should start some changes in Board structure which will take some time to complete. The program, if approved by next year's Conference after a year of study, will result in a newly composed Board not earlier than 1967 -- five years after the last modifications in Board structure were approved by the Conference.

There are a number of "principles" involved in these changes -- from the one that affirms the desirability of placing the A.A. Fellowship in primary charge of its world affairs -- to the one that expresses the security that many have felt in a nonalcoholic majority. There have been many different attitudes toward modification of the present structure expressed in and out of our Conference halls. And many different *shades* of opinion. Some believe that change was desirable but the time was not right. Others were opposed to any change.

Now, by a vote of 16 to 1 (with 1 abstaining) the Board has asked me to present some proposals to the Conference and to ask you to consider them for one year, voting on them in 1966. All of these proposals have been thoroughly discussed with Bill and have his full approval.

Before these were drawn up, both Class A and Class B members of the Board spent considerable time reviewing Board structure and the actions of previous Conferences affecting structural changes. Your Trustees undertook to assess all the factors involved, dispassionately and practically -- with these conclusions:

'Mixed' Board

1. The concept of a "mixed" Board -- that is, both nonalcoholics and alcoholics -- is a good one and should be continued. But there is no longer any need for a "majority of one" nonalcoholics. Remember that when the Board was organized this way nobody had had more than three years of sobriety. Last year's Conference Delegates averaged 11 years of active membership in A.A. We believe that a proportion of one-third nonalcoholics to two-thirds alcoholics will preserve the benefits of the mixed Board while it meets the needs of a growing movement. This will, moreover, express internally and to the public our high regard for the counsel of our nonalcoholic friends.

Board Chairmanship

2. The present bylaw which makes the Board chairmanship open to either a nonalcoholic or alcoholic should be unchanged. The Board should remain free to select as its chairman the Trustee who in its judgment could best carry this responsibility.

Class A Rotation

3. We have examined the practicability of a rotation plan for Class A Trustees and believe that the following changes are desirable but with the clear understanding that members of the April 1966 Board are not to be affected by these changes:

a. There should be established for Class A Trustees a three-year term which may be followed by two successive three-year terms -- nine years in all.

b. There should be a six-year term for the chairman but this tenure should not be restricted by the 3-3-3 terms of Class A Trustees. Thus, conceivably, a Class A Trustee might serve nine years and then become chairman, in which case his tenure would continue for another six years.

Regional Class B Trustees

4. The Board has also examined the method of selection and the functioning of Class B Trustees -- the alcoholic Board members. The Regional Trustee electoral system was approved by the 1962 Conference and the elections of 1963 and 1964 have shown the merits of this procedure. We believe that we are now ready:

a. To improve year-round liaison between Board and membership by expanding the four U.S. Regional trusteeships to five, and the one Canadian Regional trusteeship to two.

b. To follow the same Regional electoral system for the U.S. which then would give each U.S. Region two four-year terms with a two-year gap rather than the present one four-year term with a two-year gap.

c. To ask Canada to set up two Regions to include all provinces; then to apply the U.S. electoral system but with no gap between four-year terms.

General Service Class B Trustees

5. The Board believes that the policy of having four Class B General Service Trustees has been very important to the prudent stewardship of the Fellowship -- and particularly the General Service Office. These Trustees (sometimes known as New York or "in-town" Trustees) have been selected by the Nominating Committee for their specialized business and professional experience -- capabilities that are needed in handling the affairs of a growing movement. Guided by the success of this method of selection, the Board suggests:

a. That the number of this type of Trustee be increased from four to seven; and that four of these seven continue to come from the New York commuting area while the other three come from anywhere in the U.S. and Canada.

b. That the General Service Trustees from the New York commuting area be nominated and elected as they now are.

c. That the General Service Trustees from outside New York be elected as follows:

The Board would set up "specifications" to cover the kind of business and professional qualifications needed to fill a vacancy. All states and provinces would be asked to submit qualified names at least six months before the April Conference. The Conference Committee on Trustees would be invited to meet with the Trustees' Nominating Committee in joint session at the time of the January Board meeting to discuss the entire slate and to reduce it to four names. At the Conference annual meeting, the entire Conference would use Third Legacy procedures to select one name for election by the Board.

Size of Board

6. The structural modifications we have discussed now add up to a 21-man Board compared to the present nineteen. When all changes have come about, the Board will be made up of. . .

Seven Nonalcoholics (Class A) compared to ten today
 Seven Regional Trustees (Class B - 5 U.S. - 2 Canadian)
 compared to 4 U.S. and 1 Canadian today
 Seven General Service Trustees (Class B - 4 N.Y. - 3 U.S. and
 Canada) compared with 4 from N.Y. today.

Timetable

7. The Board believes that a calm, deliberate approach to these changes is essential. This is the timetable that your Trustees offer as part of these proposals:

a. First, a clear understanding that no Class A Trustee on the Board when the Conference votes on the plan are to be affected by the changed procedures and tenures; that changes will be put into effect only after there are Class A vacancies resulting from death or normal retirement.

b. Then, that this plan be taken home by all members of this Conference, considered for one year, and then voted on at the 1966 Annual Meeting of the Conference.

c. Should the 1966 Conference accept the plan by a two-thirds or better majority, then the composition of the Board would take shape in this order:

: : The two additional Regional Trustees would be added by the 1967 Conference. The increase in Board size from 19 to 21 would provide this room.

: : Class A trusteeships would be set at seven when, through normal attrition, this number was reached.

: : Then the three General Service Trustees from outside New York would be elected.

Four Proposals

The proposal that the Conference is being asked to consider for one year and to vote on in 1966 can be simply expressed:

1. That the General Service Board be increased to twenty-one, of whom seven shall be nonalcoholic and fourteen alcoholic.
2. That the alcoholic Trustees be:
 Seven Regional - five from U.S. and two from Canada.
 Seven General Service Trustees - four from New York commuting area and three from anywhere in U.S. and/or Canada.
3. That Class A trusteeships follow a rotation plan of 3-3-3 years but that the chairman's tenure of 6 years be independent of his service as a Trustee.
4. That the Board incorporate the bylaw changes necessary to provide for Class A rotation and for the additional Regional and General Service Trustees.

We entrust these proposals to your good judgment.

Trustees Meetings

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: July 5 (in Toronto), October 29, 1965; January 31 and April 25, 1966.

1965 Conference

DIGEST OF AGENDA

Monday, April 19

Registration and tour of G.S.O.
 Welcome Session and Staff Reports
 Review and Selection of Conference Committees
 Opening Dinner: Greetings by Bill and Lois
 Regular A.A. Meeting

Tuesday, April 20

Workshops: Joint Trustee and Conference Committees
 Conference Committee Meetings
 G.S.B. Report and Presentation on Trustees Plan for Structuring Board
 Policy Committee Report
 P.I.C. 30th Anniversary Report and film "Bill's Own Story"

Wednesday, April 21

Literature Report: Financial Report and Presentation
 General Service Manager's and A.A.W.S. Reports
 International Committee Report and Presentation
 Election of two Regional Trustees
 Presentations: 3-year Term for Delegates; Ex-Delegates' Attendance at Annual Meetings; A.A. Family Groups
 Area Delegates Only Meeting

Thursday, April 22

Grapevine Presentation and Discussion
 Nominating Committee Report
 Presentations: International Young People's Conventions; Attraction and Anonymity; Programs used with Beginner members; A.A. and Al-Anon Cooperation; How to attract more A.A.'s to Service Opportunities
 Interview Time: Delegates meet with Staff and all Directors

Friday, April 23

Area Delegates Meeting Report: Conference Committee Reports
 Presentation: Conference Committees: Selection and Year-Round Functions
 Monthly Sharing Plan: Pension Program
 Presentations: Conference influence on Groups, Districts, Areas; on G.S.B., G.S.O. and Grapevine

Saturday, April 24

Final Conference Brunch
 Talks by Area Delegate Chairman, G.S.B. Chairman, two retiring Regional Trustees and Bill
 Visit to Lois and Bill's home "Stepping Stones"

* * * * *

"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Throughout the Conference, time was set aside for brief presentations by panel 15 Delegates on the theme "Responsibility to Those We Serve."

In addition, there were a number of "Ask-It Basket" sessions during which questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered.

OUR GREAT RESPONSIBILITY

The Guidance of A.A.'s World Affairs

(Bill's discussion at the 1965 General Service Conference in which he endorses the Trustees' Plan for reshaping our General Service Board, A.A.'s chief agency for world service.)

Dear Members:

Speaking on behalf of A.A.'s Board of Trustees, our devoted friend and Chairman, Dr. Jack Norris, has called upon us to face a far-reaching responsibility. Future A.A. historians will no doubt record this occasion as a major turning-point in the unfoldment of our well-loved Fellowship. This is because we are now to reconsider, and perhaps to recast, the whole nature and composition of A.A.'s future world leadership. As we meditate upon this long unresolved problem, it would be well to recall that in the affairs of new societies and of nations, the determination of their ultimate leadership has ever been a matter of crucial importance. This is the teaching of all human history.

Dr. Jack has specifically requested us of Alcoholics Anonymous -- at the level of our Board of Trustees -- to assume the primary role in the conduct of A.A.'s world affairs. He has presented a detailed program for achieving this, a plan almost unanimously recommended by his fellow Trustees. Should we adopt this new concept in 1966, the chief responsibility for the guidance of our world affairs would then be shifted from the nonalcoholics of our present Board to the alcoholic Trustees of the new Board.

Our recast Board would then be composed of 14 A.A. Trustees and 7 nonalcoholic Trustees. Seven of the A.A. members would be chosen from suitable areas of the U.S. and Canada on the basis of their A.A. leadership qualifications. The remaining 7 A.A.'s would be selected on the basis of their several high standards of business, professional and administrative skills. This would add up to a balanced board of 21 members, in which the A.A.'s would function in a majority of 2 to 1. That would compare with our present Board of 10 nonalcoholics and 9 A.A.'s. The chief posts of the new Board would be open to its A.A. members at any time such a change might be desirable. For practical reasons alone, the improved balance between the three classes of Trustees should commend itself to us all.

Plan Has Deep Spiritual Values

However, the Trustees' Plan, as outlined by Dr. Jack, has far greater implications than mere practicality: it carries deep spiritual values, it is a call to the highest of A.A.'s responsibilities. In effect, it is also a declaration that A.A. has now evolved to such a point of stability and competence that it should no longer need to function under what has been, since 1938, the symbol of protective custody by nonalcoholic friends. As you know, the present structure was created long ago -- in a time when A.A. had but three Groups and only 40 members.

It is worth pausing here to recall why our General Service Board was originally so constituted. For us of A.A., the year 1938 was one of anguished uncertainty. There was no proof that alcoholics could stay sober indefinitely. Nor was there convincing evidence that we had the emotional stability to look after ourselves, even though sober. Besides, we had no public standing; people did not even know that we existed. Then, too, how many distant A.A. Groups would think of sending their money contributions to a board of trustees composed wholly of New York alcoholics? This was the climate of fear and indecision that darkly overcast us in that early time.

Nevertheless, it had already become clear that our infant society would have to head up somewhere. At the top of our growing pyramid of membership, there would need to be erected a beacon light whose illumination might carry A.A.'s message to those who

still suffered alcoholism. Lest one day its radiance be snuffed out by drinking relapses and irresponsibility, we felt sure that we dare not tend this lighthouse all by ourselves.

Some kind of certain protection we must have -- but what protection? The answer that we proposed in 1938 is now history. We requested carefully chosen nonalcoholic friends to become a majority of our projected trusteeship, and we agreed to make this status legal. We further stipulated that, traditionally, there should always be a nonalcoholic chairman and likewise a nonalcoholic treasurer. Frankly admitting that A.A. would absolutely have to have such a protectorate, we somberly estimated that, should all the A.A. Trustees get drunk, our Board could nevertheless continue to function by reason of its nonalcoholic guardianship!

Happily, we can now smile at all these excessive fears and elaborate precautions. During the past 27 years, only two A.A. Trustees have been waylaid by alcohol. Meanwhile, our message has been carried worldwide, and most effectively indeed. It is probably no exaggeration to estimate that one-half of our present membership, and much of our remarkable unity has been due, in large measure, to the efforts of A.A. world servants, both on the Board of Trustees, and in the General Service Office.

We Need Not Fear Instability

Of course we have sometimes witnessed emotional storms; but none more serious than those which afflict most other societies. In every single instance these disturbances have been successfully overcome by the immense spirit of dedication that has always characterized every level of our worldwide effort. The record speaks for itself. Today we know that we need not fear alcoholism, nor excessive emotional instability.

Next, let us inquire into what has been the value of our nonalcoholic Trustees over all these years. Without hesitation, I can tell you that their value has been quite beyond reckoning. Only God could add their score. Therefore I deeply hope that a sizable contingent of these friends will continue to remain with us, just as our new plan provides.

In the days when A.A. was unknown, it was the nonalcoholic Trustees who held up our hands before the general public. They supplied us with ideas that are now a part of the working structure of our headquarters. They voluntarily spent hours on end, working side by side with us and among the grubbier details. They gave freely of their professional and financial wisdom. Now and then they helpfully mediated our difficulties.

In the early years especially, their very presence on our Board was quite able to command full confidence and respect of many far-away Groups. Meanwhile, they assured the world around us of A.A.'s worth. These are the unusual services which indeed they still render. Then, too, these are the men who stood fast during that exciting but perilous time between 1940 and 1950 when A.A.'s unity and its collective responsibility were put to the acid test -- a time our Twelve Traditions were being forged out of the lessons of that experience.

Having myself been a constant resident of A.A.'s house of world service for over a quarter of a century, no one could better understand what these devoted friends have meant to us. To gratefully set my testimony of their magnificent contributions on the record of this meeting is something for the deepest and most enduring of satisfactions. Nor could any expression of our gratitude be complete unless I were to tell you of the indispensable contribution that was once made to A.A.'s welfare by a nonalcoholic friend and Trustee. I speak of a man that many of you know -- our onetime Chairman, Mr. Bernard Smith. During the

most serious crisis that this Fellowship has ever experienced, it was Bern who persuaded us to meet and to shoulder our clear and rightful obligations.

As individuals, it must be confessed that we A.A.'s have never been over-anxious to meet heavy responsibilities. All of us were at first driven to A.A. under the lash of alcohol. Arriving in the midst of the new-found life, we were soon confronted with the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. More often than not, we proceeded to adopt these principles in a rather piecemeal fashion. However, as time went by, the quality of our conformity began to improve. We commenced to practice A.A. principles because we knew them to be right for us, even though many were still difficult. Nonetheless, it was a very long time before many of us could come to the point where we would accept our heavier obligations with that full and joyful willingness which finally grants to us a consistent spiritual effectiveness.

It is also observable that, like other people, we A.A.'s are apt to resist any proposal for great change, especially when all seems to go well. Often enough, these reluctancies have been based upon our fears. But sometimes they have represented a genuine prudence. This latter quality of conservatism has occasionally prevented ill-considered or hasty decisions upon important matters.

Resistance to Conference Recalled

What has been true of us as individuals has necessarily been true of A.A. as a whole. I can vividly remember the heavy opposition to the creation of our world trusteeship in 1938, to the publication of our text book "Alcoholics Anonymous" in 1939; and I still tremble when I recall the truly fierce resistance that arose when, in 1946, the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous was first projected. In those times it was seriously believed by a majority of A.A.'s that the temptations and risks of such complex ventures as these would be far too much for us. However, we can now thank God that we finally did face and accept those vital and clear-cut responsibilities.

Nevertheless we found on each of these occasions that we had to be strongly persuaded of the absolute need for change. There had to be manifest a solid core of constructive and convincing personal leadership.

This is exactly what our remarkable friend, Bern Smith, gave to us when in 1950, after years of great heat but little light, we had failed to arrive at a decision to form A.A.'s General Service Conference. It was his personal leadership that saved the day.

Let me now background this statement. By 1946, certain facts of A.A. life were becoming visible. Our trusteeship -- then called The Alcoholic Foundation -- was becoming more and more isolated as our Groups fanned out over the globe. Indeed, the only linkage between our Board and all these thousands of members consisted of a few tireless A.A. gals at the General Service Office, Dr. Bob and myself. The Trustees themselves were virtually unknown. Dr. Bob had fallen ill, perhaps fatally. Our linkage was perishable and far too thin. Hence some of us felt it imperative that our Board of Trustees should be directly related without delay to A.A. as a whole.

There was still another reason: a majority of our Groups had already declared that they would no longer live under the protection and management of their local founders and old-timers -- no matter how well-loved these were. For better or worse, our Groups were taking the decision to look after themselves.

This was the A.A. revolution which led to the writing of Tradition Two, whose principles of A.A. function provide that the group conscience shall be the final authority for all active services and that trusted servants named by the Groups shall act in their behalf.

Certainly our long isolated Board members were trusted servants. But it was nonetheless true that these Trustees had no direct connection to the group conscience of our Society, nor were they dir-

ectly accountable to it. It was therefore becoming evident that we here at New York were still operating as a protectorate, something that had by then become obsolete and quite inconsistent with the provisions and spirit of A.A.'s second Tradition.

Consequently it was proposed to assemble a general service conference of delegates who could squarely meet these deficiencies. As news of this project got into circulation, resistance began to mount. The more the conference was urged, the more the opposition dug in. Many A.A.'s were deeply frightened. They imagined themselves engulfed in a wave of prestige-seeking, shabby politics, financial troubles and all the rest of it. Under such conditions, many good members were quite unable to see the urgent need for radical change. Observing their protests, our Board naturally concluded that A.A.'s most emphatically did not want a general service conference. I'm afraid, too, that the growing impasse was made still worse by my incessant bull-dozing of the conference issue.

Then Bern Smith came upon the scene. With matchless diplomacy and tact he began to point out that the actual risk of the conference venture was, in his belief, far less than the *risk of doing nothing at all* -- a policy which he thought would in the future result in a collapse, or certainly a grievous impairment of A.A. at its very heart of service. He deeply felt that we must not risk such a debacle at our headquarters, a calamity from which we might never recover.

He also continued to remind us that *self-direction was the very first responsibility* of every democratic society, such as ours had in Tradition Two, said it was. As we know, these views of Bern's were finally accepted, and I shall never forget that wonderful day in his office when the Trustees' Committee on Structure recommended immediate creation of the General Service Conference of A.A. To our friend Bern we therefore owe it that we sit in this gathering today.

Certainly his story has a deep and clear relevance to this all-important matter of A.A.'s future leadership; the question that is again before us and one which has been ten years under debate.

It is ever so evident that Dr. Jack has been performing for us a similar service of unique importance. To him and to his fellow Trustees, we therefore owe a similar tribute. It is greatly due to Dr. Jack's wise and patient leadership in this time of change that we have the Trustees' Plan before us this afternoon -- a plan, which if adopted, would mark the last basic step in the evolution of A.A.'s world service structure.

Inspiring and Heartwarming Event

Most assuredly, I hardly need say that I *do* endorse the Trustees' Plan: its unfoldment in this meeting is one of the most inspiring and heartwarming events of my entire A.A. life.

Finally, let us reflect together upon the high spiritual content of this all-important plan.

As we know, all A.A. progress can be reckoned in terms of just two words: humility and responsibility. Our whole spiritual development can be accurately measured by our degree of adherence to these magnificent standards. Ever deepening humility, accompanied by an ever greater willingness to accept and to act upon clear-cut obligations -- these are truly our touchstones for all growth in the life of the spirit. They hold up to us the very essence of right being and right doing. It is by them that we are enabled to find and to do God's will.

Let us therefore consider the spiritual gifts which our friends have today offered for A.A.'s future welfare. They have offered to reduce their numbers by three. Being still a board majority, and still holding its chief posts, our nonalcoholics have all these years been cast in the role of guardianship, a responsibility that they have never been called upon to meet. Therefore this old-time symbol of protection has long since become meaningless.

(Continued on Page 41)

BILL: 'WHAT HAPPENED TO THOSE WHO LEFT?'

A.A. members can soberly ask themselves what became of the 600,000 alcoholics who approached the Fellowship during the past 30 years but "who did not stay," Bill W., surviving co-founder, suggested in a moving address to the Conference at its closing session.

"How much and how often did we fail all these?" Bill asked. "When we remember that in the 30 years of A.A.'s existence we have reached less than ten per cent of those who might have been willing to approach us, we begin to get an idea of the immensity of our task, and of the responsibilities with which we will always be confronted."

In no circumstances should members feel that Alcoholics Anonymous is the know-all and do-all of alcoholism, Bill noted, citing the "perhaps one hundred agencies" in the United States and Canada alone that are engaged in "research, alcohol education and rehabilitation."

"We should very seriously ask ourselves how many alcoholics have gone on drinking simply because we have failed to cooperate in good spirit with these many agencies -- whether they be good, bad or indifferent," the co-founder remarked. "No alcoholic should go mad or die merely because he did not come straight to A.A. at the beginning."

All of the basic components of A.A. were supplied by others, Bill pointed out, "although we drunks certainly did put A.A. together. Here, especially, our maxim should be 'Let's be friendly with our friends.'"

Bill said that at certain great turning points in A.A. history, members have backed away from what should have been "clearly

visible responsibilities." He cited the old-timers who almost prevented preparation of the Big Book "because some avowed we did not need it," while others shrank from the risks involved.

There was "a great outcry" against formation of the General Service Conference, he recalled. "There was almost no belief that such a linkage could be effectively forged; even an attempt at such a project would ruin us, many thought."

The spiritual assets of A.A. have "in God's time" invariably come to exceed even such large liabilities, Bill said. "A.A. recovery goes forward on a large scale. Practice of A.A.'s Twelve Traditions has amazingly cemented our unity. Our General Service Office and General Service Conference have made possible a wide spreading of our message at home and abroad. Our pains and our necessities first called us reluctantly to responsibility. But in the latter years a joyous willingness and a confident faith have more and more permeated all the affairs of our Fellowship."

Fear of negative factors should not deceive members into absurd rationalizations, Bill suggested. "In the fear of accumulated wealth and bureaucracy, we should not discover an alibi for failure to pay A.A.'s legitimate service expenses. For fear of controversy, our leadership should not go timid when lively debate and forthright action is a necessity. And for fear of accumulating prestige and power, we should never fail to endow our trusted leaders with proper authority to act for us."

"Let us never fear needed change," Bill urged. "Once a need becomes clearly apparent in an individual, a Group, or in A.A. as a whole, it has long since been found out that we cannot stand still and look the other way."

On Being Responsible

Closing Comments by Dr. John L. Norris

There is an important difference between being responsible "for" someone and being responsible "to" them, Dr. John L. Norris, nonalcoholic chairman of the Board of Trustees, suggested in his closing remarks to the Fifteenth Conference at its Saturday morning session.

"If we are responsible for somebody, if we are responsible for someone, this can take the joy out of 'responsibility,' it can make responsibility a burden -- and make someone else a burden," he said, pointing out that the feeling of responsibility can be closely linked to the feeling of hostility in certain situations.

"When we say we are responsible to someone, we imply a part of the slogan of 'Live and Let Live,'" Dr. Norris said. "But I never saw people who said 'Live and Let Live' and were so consistently living and helping to live, as Alcoholics Anonymous."

The concept of responsibilities to those we serve, which was the theme of the Conference, also involves A.A.'s basic philosophy of "attraction rather than promotion," the Trustee Chairman pointed out. Sometimes people who have found a meaning for life and joy, happiness and acceptance find it very difficult "to sit on our hands and wait" for people to be attracted to the A.A. program, he noted.

"We think, 'If they could only do things our way, how simple it would be.' But if they did it our way, if we forced the program down anyone's throat, it wouldn't mean anything to them. So we have to wait for them to see the light themselves. And while we wait, we have to try to be the kind of people whose way is attractive."

(Continued on Page 41)

'A Million Dividends'

Comments by Judge John Murtagh

"I have given just a little and, like yourselves, I have gotten a million dividends."

In other words, one of A.A.'s long-time nonalcoholic friends, currently a Class A Trustee of the General Service Board, summed up an association with the Fellowship that dates back to 1950.

The speaker was the Hon. John Murtagh, Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of the City of New York, addressing the Saturday morning closing session of the Fifteenth Conference.

Judge Murtagh recalled that he had encountered a "recovered" A.A. in 1940 but that he began "to identify" with the problem of alcoholism in 1950, when he first became a judge. "I looked down at those faces, this whole parade charged with disorderly conduct, and I was enough of a lawyer to know that, to be guilty of disorderly conduct in some way, you have to cause a breach of the peace. My instinct was that these fellows either had not disturbed anyone, or, if they had, the cop who had locked them up could not identify who did what."

The judge said that, finding little interest in the problem among his colleagues, he visited New York's Skid Row, the Bowery and talked with workers in social agencies. His first lesson in alcoholism came, he recalled, through the visits of an A.A. member who finally persuaded him to attend an A.A. meeting.

Later, he was impressed by the agreement on the efficacy of A.A. on the part of those attending the Yale Summer School on alcoholism. "I think I was perceptive in that I realized then that

(Continued on Page 32)

STRENGTHENING CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

"The real importance of the Conference Committee is only now emerging," Herb Morse, General Service Manager, reminded the Delegates in a summary presentation on Conference Committee Workshops. "Like most things in A.A., when the problem is clear, the solution is usually at hand. Today we have a larger Conference than ever before . . . and it will grow larger, never smaller. The Conference has an ever greater involvement in G.S.O. matters -- because such involvement has proven beneficial to us and to the movement as a whole. Thirdly, we find a growing complexity of services. To 'keep it simple' at the level of 12,000 Groups means more services -- essential services, because the Groups need them.

"All this -- larger Conferences, greater involvement, growing services -- point up the need for the most practical use of the Conference Committee."

Beginning with the first Conference in 1951, all Conference Committees have been created to meet specific needs as these needs became apparent to the Areas, to Delegates, to Staff Members at G.S.O. and to the General Service Board. Until recently, however, there has been no coordinated attempt to analyze the scope, structure and functions of the Committee system to determine if it could be made more productive.

A first step in this direction was taken at the 1964 Conference with the scheduling of the first Conference "workshop" on Committees. Following this, G.S.O. prepared a careful study of the development and functions of all Conference Committees. This study was used as the basis for scheduling, at the 1965 Conference, "workshops" of all Conference Committees. The purpose of these sessions was to achieve a consensus on ways of operating within the Committee structure to make the Conference as a whole a more useful instrument of service to the movement.

As a result of these workshops, there is now basic agreement on what each Committee can and should do, and how it should do it. It was agreed, for example, that members of each Committee should be chosen by lot at the January G.S.B. Policy Committee meeting, that the number of members of each Committee should be larger than in previous years, that all Delegates should be active members of a Committee (although a Delegate retains the

right to refuse to serve on a specific Committee) and that the Co-Chairman of a Committee should succeed to the full chairmanship of a Committee immediately following the close of a Conference.

* * *

Herb said the picture of "an informed and fully manned Conference Committee" is beginning to take shape. "We see committee programs working superbly in the future provided we continue to accept all the opportunities they afford."

Herb pointed out that the allocation of more time for Committee work -- with Delegates taking particular problems to particular Committees -- will mean that less time is available for full Conference discussions.

"We can't do both," he said. "We can't have ample Conference time and ample Committee meeting time without dangerously overloading the agenda. Most Delegates will find the atmosphere of Committee meetings conducive to detailed discussion and productive of useful opinion. Others will miss the stimulation of the full Conference session. But we all seem to think that these changes will be most beneficial.

"Certainly, there will be less likelihood of a Delegate's feeling that he has not participated as much as he should have or, on the other extreme, that his time has been wasted by what seemed to be endless discussion of matters that were not on his 'must' list."

Herb said he foresaw that Delegates would arrive at the 1966 Conference better informed on Conference responsibilities, and that Delegates would "get an earlier start on Conference matters -- using the first year of their two-year term to better advantage."

Herb's summary covered the main points developed by Leo Burns of Massachusetts, Tom Allen of California and Martin Elgeti of Alberta, Canada, who participated in the panel on "Conference Committees."

30th Anniversary International Convention

More than 6,000 persons had registered to attend the 30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A. in Toronto, Canada July 2-4. Herb Morse, Chairman of the Convention Committee reported to the Delegates. Registrations had been received from 49 States, all Canadian Provinces, England, Scotland, France, Australia, Central America, South America and other areas, he said. He saluted the Canadian host Groups for having exceeded by more than 500 their target of 2,000 advance registrations and noted that more than 400 volunteers are working with the host committee.

The Convention will open informally with a dance the evening of Thursday, July 1 and will close with a "Big Show" featuring special entertainment the evening of Sunday, July 4.

Many luncheons, dinners and special gatherings, in addition to the formal program, are being planned by interested individuals. A luncheon for Delegates has been scheduled for July 3.

The Convention program will include 23 non-A.A. speakers at nine large daytime meetings. Expenses of non-A.A. speakers will be paid out of the Convention Fund. All members of the Board of

Trustees are expected to be present. A.A.'s who will speak at the Convention will be selected from Convention registrants who will pay their own expenses.

A special meeting featuring only Canadian A.A. members has been scheduled and there will be a "Round the World" meeting limited to speakers from outside the U.S. and Canada.

Bill W., surviving co-founder, will deliver two major addresses, telling his personal story of recovery from alcoholism on Friday evening and speaking on the Convention theme, "Responsibility," Saturday night. He will also deliver the closing remarks at the Sunday morning "spiritual" meeting.

Lois will accompany Bill to Toronto for the A.A. Convention and will also be active in the convention program of the Al-Anon Family Groups.

Registrations for the A.A. Convention will close May 15 at G.S.O. and re-open Monday, June 28 at the Royal York Hotel in Toronto. Convention accommodations for 20,000 persons are available in Toronto.

THE INFLUENCE OF THE CONFERENCE

One of the principal objectives of the Fifteenth Conference -- in tune with its theme, "Responsibility to Those We Serve" -- was to explore the degree to which the Conference structure has actually served the Fellowship, and the influence it has had on various segments of the movement.

Two special presentations were devoted to this analysis. In one of them, four Delegates (Ralph Gordon of Texas, Bill Griffith of Oregon, Bob Clayton of New Brunswick, Canada and Claude Mill-sap of Alaska) discussed "Conference Influence on Groups, Districts and Areas." In the second panel, Dr. Jack Norris, Chairman of the General Service Board of Trustees, Jim Masterson, Trustee from California and Ann Macfarlane of the General Service Office reviewed "Conference Influence on the General Service Board, G.S.O. and The Grapevine."

All speakers agreed that the Conference has been an important influence on the development and growth of the Fellowship during the past 15 years. The only reservations expressed were to the effect the Conference conceivably could have been more influential if all Delegates and the movement as a whole had elected to take advantage of the opportunities offered.

Older Members More Active

Ralph Gordon said the influence of the Conference on the Districts and the Areas "has gradually increased, gaining momentum each year as it is being transmitted through the Delegates down the chain to the Committee Members, to the General Service Representatives and to the individual members. He said this influence is reflected in the increased activity of older members "who are becoming more and more aware of the three Legacies and the structure of A.A."

"The Conference is radiating the magnetism of bringing those members who are floating around the periphery of A.A. into the center, into the heart, of this Fellowship," he reported.

In the words of Bill Griffith, "Through the Conference and its activities, Groups have become more conscious of the value and the need for world service." Bill quoted an A.A. member he had talked with: "The Conference breathes life into the phrase 'World Service' and makes it a living, real thing." He said that a review of A.A.'s growth in Oregon indicated that Groups in the Area had been influenced progressively "for the betterment and advancement of A.A."

He cited the work of the Conference Literature Committee and other projects authorized by the Conference as examples of activities praised by Oregon Groups.

Increased Harmony Cited

Bob Clayton reviewed some of the problems encountered in developing a sound Third Legacy structure in the New Brunswick-P.E.I. Areas. He said he thought the influence of the General Service Conference had produced:

1. Increased harmony among Groups in the Districts.
2. A desire to help weaker Groups and to start new Groups in the District.

3. A greater awareness by Committee Members of the meaning and wisdom of A.A. Traditions.
4. A gradual improvement in the selection of Committee Members.
5. An improvement in attitude toward world services.
6. A better understanding of A.A. as a whole.
7. A personal satisfaction to trusted servants "who have given their best in service."

Dr. Norris, as nonalcoholic Chairman of the General Service Board, echoed the expression of another G.S.O. speaker, who, earlier in the week, had said: "I don't know what we at G.S.O. would do without the Conference." Dr. Norris, who is Associate Medical Director of Eastman Kodak Company, noted that other nonalcoholic Trustees spent substantial time attending Conference sessions "so that we can, at Board meetings, make decisions with the sense of the movement in back of us and with confidence that the decisions we make are made as you would make them if our positions were reversed."

The Board Chairman reminded the Conference that, "legally, the Board is responsible to the Conference, but not bound by it." He pointed out that the Board, with more "detailed knowledge of the present and past" of a situation, might conceivably have to make a decision that would apparently be contrary to action of the Conference. This has never happened in the 15 years of the Conference, he declared, adding that he doubts that it ever will. He stressed the importance of communication "and the fact that communication, unless it's two-way communication, is not communication at all."

Jim Masterson, who had been a Delegate before becoming a Trustee, said he felt the purpose of all Conferences "has been to influence."

Constructive Brand of 'Influence'

"The kind of influence we speak of must not be confused with politics, mandates, pressure, lobbying or anything of the kind," he stressed. "We speak of that brand of influence which is concerned with optimistic and constructive ideas without being naive, that type which demands realistic and honest expressions of ideas and opinions."

Jim said the "people of the Board, G.S.O. and the Grapevine want to be influenced, want very sincerely to hear what you have to say, honestly, not 'what you think that they want you to say.'" To deprive these people of Delegates' "honest" opinions, ideas and experiences also deprives them of the opportunity to use Delegates' influence "when it becomes their final obligation and responsibility to make decisions, set policy and pass judgment."

Ann Macfarlane, a Staff Member at G.S.O. since 1947, three years before the first Conference, said "The most important influence that the Conference has had on G.S.O. might be summed up in one word, 'guidance.' There are innumerable influences, some direct and some more subtle and not so apparent," Ann declared. "And they all have been good."

ATTRACTING MORE A.A.'S TO SERVICE OPPORTUNITIES

Sound and continuing sponsorship of new members and increased awareness of the Delegates' vital role are the keys to attracting more A.A.'s to General Service opportunities, it was suggested during one of the featured presentations at the Fifteenth Conference. Area Delegates who participated were Leo Rayburn of Arizona, Chairman, Bish Mathis of Mississippi and Don Marquard of Nebraska. Bill W. concluded the presentation by reading extracts from his writings in the Third Legacy in which the early experience of the movement in developing and supporting its service functions is outlined.

The material quoted by Bill appears under the heading, "Leadership in A.A.: Ever a Vital Need," beginning on page 123 of the latest edition of the Manual. Its theme is the concept that "no society can function well without able leadership in all its levels, and A.A. can be no exception."

Bish said that his sponsors had made him aware that he could "repay" their efforts by trying to offer to another, as soon as possible, "what they had attempted to pass on to me." Bish said there were numerous ways in which the A.A. program had "opened up" service opportunities to him: "Good beginning sponsorship, an early vision of the immensity of our Fellowship and a sincere desire to become an active part of it and share its benefits."

Bish said that, by taking an active interest in new members, "you can be in the midst of a circle of new-found friends who are anxious to share with you their growth experience." He said that interest in General Services in his Area had been developed "by letting good A.A. members know that there was a job to be done and that they were needed to help do it."

Don said that the second Delegate from his Area had inspired him to understand "that this was quite a widespread Fellowship" and that it was "here to stay if, and only if, we all did our part in supporting it."

"Now I believe it is our responsibility to try and make others realize just how important they are to all of us here and to the welfare of our Society as a whole," Don pointed out. "I believe it is the responsibility of the Delegate to encourage more attention to our Second Legacy, our Twelve Traditions."

Don said Groups in his Area, "surely a prime example of A.A. everywhere," are sometimes so involved in personal recovery that unity (of the movement) is almost forgotten. There are never enough meetings where the Traditions are given any consideration. If it were not for a minority of understanding and insistent members, General Services would be pushed into the background."

Importance of Beginner A.A. Programs

The importance of soundly planned "beginner programs" to give newcomers a basic understanding of A.A. was stressed in an interesting four-part presentation at the Fifteenth Conference. Participants were: Bob Daly of Minnesota, Hollis Akins of Arkansas, George Schnatz of New York and John Tkachuk of Saskatchewan.

A four-session program was described by Bob. During the first class, one full hour is devoted to the First Step and to classifying all the Steps in basic grouping. The second session class for discussions in depth of the Third, Fourth, Eighth and Ninth Steps. The Second Step is the sole topic of the third class while the fourth session reviews and summarizes all the Steps. A special attempt is made to reassure the newcomer that the Steps are suggested only, that there are no musts in A.A. and that his anonymity will be protected.

In his Area, Hollis reported, Beginners' Meetings have been held successfully for 26 years. Newcomers are encouraged to attend such meetings for six weeks, with special emphasis on the benefits to be derived from reading the Big Book. After a newcomer has been on the program for six weeks, he is eligible to act as chairman of a Beginners' Meeting and can select his own sponsor, or let the Group select one for him.

Six Groups in his Area are currently holding Beginners' Meetings, George noted. The sessions usually start about an hour before regular meetings and run approximately 45 minutes. There are four main objectives: (1) To stimulate discussion of the Twelve Steps, (2) To answer questions the newcomer may have concerning the program and structure of A.A., (3) To help the newcomer to face up to other personal problems and (4) To ease the newcomer's "adjustment" to A.A. Two types of meetings are held in the Area. In one, a discussion of problems, "adjustment," and questions is held and is moderated by an older member, who, because of past experience, is able to answer many of the newcomer's questions. The other type is the discussion of a Step each week, taking them in order, and explaining and discussing them with the new members. The meetings are also attended by older members who join in on the round table discussion.

Describing a series of Beginners' Meetings for inmate alcoholics in his Area, John pointed out that the Johns Hopkins "20 questions" are used to enable the inmate to determine if he is an alcoholic. Once he makes such a decision, he is invited to participate in a program of 14 weekly meetings on the fundamentals of A.A. and on the individual Steps.

Conference Attendance by Ex-Delegates Rejected

Should former Delegates be permitted to attend annual meetings of the General Service Conference "without voice or vote" and at their own expense.

This question, in various forms, has been considered at a number of earlier Conferences. Those favoring the proposal have argued that it would be useful for Delegates to continue their association with Conference meetings and could encourage them to continue to be active in service functions in their Areas. Since such ex-Delegates would not be permitted to speak or vote in Conference sessions, it was suggested, they would not be in a position to

influence discussions or debates.

Delegates to the Fifteenth Meeting were not disposed to change the present arrangements which have no provision for Conference attendance by "non-participant" Area members. At the same time they recognized that occasions might arise in the future where the welfare of the Fellowship might be enhanced by permitting an ex-Delegate to attend a Conference by special invitation.

A motion to this effect was carried with only a single dissenting vote.

FIVE NEW TRUSTEES ON SERVICE BOARD

A highlight of the Conference was the election, by Third legacy procedure, of two nominees to be Class B (alcoholic) Regional Trustees from the United States, and one for Canada.

This year it was the turn of the West Central Region and of the Northeast Region to submit the names of candidates to serve four-year terms on the General Service Board. All states in each Region were invited last year to propose nominees, but not all availed themselves of this privilege.

At the Conference, voting on each candidate was limited to Delegates from the Region that had been asked to propose nominees, and to members of two committees: the Conference Committee on Trustees and the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board.

R. Fay Brown of North Dakota, was selected as the candidate from the West Central Region and Frank Russell of Massachusetts was the candidate from the Northeast Region. Tom Breen, coming from Winnipeg, Manitoba, was the Canadian selection. (At the meeting of the General Service Board on April 26, following the close of the Conference, all three Trustee nominees were formally elected to the Board.)

Grapevine Presentation

The special presentation of the A.A. Grapevine was opened by the Chairman of the Grapevine Corporate Board, Mary Bernson, who spoke briefly of the operation of the Grapevine during the past year.

Then she introduced Bob Roy, Delegate from French-speaking Canada, and others. Bob announced the publication of the first French A.A. magazine, *La Vigne AA*, which contains selections from the A.A. Grapevine. He said that the translation, editing and publishing effort of this journal is done on a volunteer basis and it will appear six times annually.

Following a short talk by Dave Bancroft (Class B Trustee) on the history of *La Vigne AA* and a few words from Bruce Wight, Chairman of the Grapevine Conference Committee, on the future circulation of the Grapevine, Mary introduced the Grapevine staff.

Using as a reference the current May issue, which had been distributed to each Delegate, the Grapevine Staff in an informal panel meeting, described their individual and specific services and functions in relation to the publishing of A.A.'s international journal. Articles and stories appearing in the issue were discussed and their gradual evolution up to the final revision explained. The selection of material, production deadlines, schedules and P.O. Box feature were reviewed, showing the tie-in with artists, art material and special features.

It was announced that the Grapevine is publishing five pamphlets, reprints of the Grapevine's contemplated "Best of Bill," which will be available for sale for the first time at the Thirtieth Anniversary International Convention in Toronto. The subjects covered are Humility, Love, Fear, Honesty and Faith.

(Other information from the Grapevine is covered in the Editor's report in the section including all G.S.O. reports to the Conference.)

New Nonalcoholic Trustees

Delegates also "reapproved" the action of the General Service Board in having elected Dr. Travis Dancy of Montreal as the first Class A (nonalcoholic) Trustee from Canada. Dr. Dancy had joined the Board formally in January, following earlier approval of his nomination in a mail poll of the Delegates.

Similarly, the Delegates approved the Board's nomination of Dr. Vincent Dole of New York City as the General Service Trustee to fill the vacancy occurring with the resignation of Ivan Underwood of Rye, N.Y. at the April 26 meeting of the Board.

Mr. Underwood, a retired export executive of Republic Steel Corporation, had been particularly helpful to the Fellowship in his contacts with A.A. members and Groups during frequent trips abroad. Mr. Underwood, who had joined the Board in 1956, had also played a key role in "interpreting" A.A. to nonalcoholics in other countries.

In his response to a warm tribute by Dr. Norris, Mr. Underwood said service on the Board had been a "wonderful, wonderful experience." Mr. Underwood said he did not believe "anyone ever retires, resigns or removes himself from A.A.'s -- whether he has been in as an active member or by association." He indicated that he would continue to "be around, in one way or another."

A.A. Family Groups Discussed

Should non-A.A.'s hold office in a regular A.A. Group?

Should a Group which includes non-A.A.'s as regular members carry "A.A." in its name?

These two questions were responsible for thoughtful discussion of a subject on which the General Service Office had requested guidance. Participants in the panel included Rick Schreiber of California, Wayne Reed of Tennessee, Jan Armstrong of British Columbia and Harry Hallock of California.

Discussion revealed that some groups that call themselves "A.A. Family Groups" have nonalcoholics as officers while others consider nonalcoholics as members.

It was pointed out that this can lead to confusion and misunderstanding. As the legend of the A.A. World Directory has suggested for many years, "Traditionally, any two or more alcoholics meeting together for purposes of sobriety may consider themselves an A.A. Group, provided that, as a group, they are self-supporting and have no outside affiliation."

At the same time the discussion made it clear that nonalcoholics have traditionally always been welcome at "open" meetings of A.A. Groups. It was noted that there is a basic difference between Groups that identify themselves as part of "A.A." while enrolling nonalcoholics as active members and (2) A.A. Groups which welcome nonalcoholics at open meetings.

Underlying the discussion was a basic theme of gratitude for the interest of nonalcoholics. At the same time, the Delegates appeared to express the consensus of the movement that A.A., by definition, is a Fellowship limited to alcoholics.

Delegates were overwhelmingly of the opinion that non-A.A.'s should not hold office in a regular A.A. Group, and that a Group with non-A.A.'s as regular members should not carry "A.A." in its name.

A.A. AND AL-ANON COOPERATION

The Traditional A.A. policy of cooperation, but not affiliation, with Al-Anon Family Groups was reaffirmed by a formal vote of the Fifteenth Conference, following a presentation in which a number of Delegates described relations between the two movements in their Areas.

It was first noted that Al-Anon groups had grown from 50 in 1951 to 2,500 in 35 countries in 1965. "These groups were formed to be helpful to the family and friends of alcoholics," a Staff Member reminded the Conference, "and the idea is nearly as old as A.A." She referred to the extensive discussion on the subject that had taken place at the 1952 General Service Conference when Delegates had, in effect, identified Al-Anon as a "distinct entity." The 1952 Conference had also approved unanimously "the work that Lois and Bill have done to encourage and support the sound growth of the . . . movement."

Area Delegates who participated in the 1965 discussion included Charlie Carballo of Puerto Rico, Frank Chase of New York, and Darrell McCleskey of New Mexico. Jim Masterson, Regional Trustee from California also took part in the panel.

Charlie said that in Puerto Rico cooperation between the two movements was noticeable mainly in social activities. He commented that "This is the help they always gave us in our 'wet' social activities with the difference that, obviously, they are much more willing now than then." The "real cooperation" that might be expected between the two Societies is not being offered by either, he reported. Noting that the "social conventionalism" of the island's culture was a handicap to cooperative action, Charlie said gossip "or the fear of gossip" had caused certain difficulties in the Area.

"We are growing and consequently we have to suffer growing pains," he declared. "It is our hope to lessen our problems as we go on gaining maturity as individuals, as Groups and as Fellowships."

Frank said that Al-Anon had been an invaluable source of help to him in Twelfth Step work in Southeastern New York, where the movement has 60 groups. "All too often, the attitude of the uninformed family of an alcoholic is: 'Take him, he's yours!'" Frank said. "Al-Anon changes this completely. It also gives the family a common interest without involving them in the alcoholic's A.A. program."

Frank declared that it had become "very obvious" to him that there was a great need for the Al-Anon program to help the families of alcoholics. He said he thought Al-Anon had become "the greatest single source" of referrals to A.A.

Jim, whose wife is a member of Al-Anon, was enthusiastic in supporting the concept of cooperation between A.A. and Al-Anon.

He said that Al-Anon had helped him a great deal in maintaining his own A.A. sobriety. "Al-Anon gives a wife or husband a better understanding of the problem involved, making it clear just what an alcoholic has to do to remain sober," Jim noted. "It also makes it clear that remaining sober is the most important thing in the spouse's life." He said that in his Area in California Al-Anon wives or husbands attend open A.A. meetings "but do not voice opinions."

Monthly Sharing Plan Extended

The 1964 Conference had reviewed the testing, in six A.A. Areas, of a so-called "Monthly Sharing Plan" designed to eliminate deficit financing of G.S.O. services by encouraging the Groups to make their contributions to G.S.O. on a monthly basis. This year's Conference, following an analysis of results in the test Areas for a full year, agreed to extend the Plan to all Areas in the U.S. and Canada as rapidly as possible. (In the test Areas, the percentage of Groups contributing increased from 62 in 1963 to 69 in 1964 and contributions increased from \$27,165 in 1963 to \$32,590 in 1964, or 20 per cent.)

Under the Plan, a Group sends to G.S.O. each month approximately 1/12th of its "normal" contribution for a year. G.S.O., instead of acknowledging each individual contribution as received, sends each Group a quarterly acknowledgment. The form used records a Group's contributions on a cumulative basis so that each Group can determine readily whether it is "behind or ahead" of its intended annual contribution.

In the case of Monthly Sharing, the now traditional contributions "yardstick" of \$3.00 per year per member is translated into "25 cents per month per member."

In past years, due to the fact that the bulk of Group contributions are not received until the fourth quarter of the year, it has been necessary to finance Group services by borrowing from the A.A.W.S. publishing operation.

While adoption of the Monthly Sharing Plan may take some time, the quarterly acknowledgment procedure will go into effect now for all Groups, whether they contribute monthly or twice a year. A memorandum to Delegates, distributed at the Conference, points out that "The savings in postage, printed forms and envelopes in itself makes this change very worthwhile."

Third Year Rejected

The question of whether a three-year term of service for Area Delegates might be more valuable to the Fellowship than the two-year term that has been traditional since the founding of the Conference in 1951 has been debated at a number of earlier Conferences. The result has always been a decision that, for both practical and spiritual reasons, the two-year term should not be extended.

Delegates to the 1965 Conference followed their predecessors in endorsing the value of the two-year term.

A primary reason advanced during the discussion was the importance of encouraging the largest possible number of members to participate actively in A.A. service activities. It was generally agreed that the principle of rotation after fairly limited terms of service was valuable in stimulating interest in world services on the part of many A.A.'s.

Cite Need To Gain Experience

The minority supporting the three-year term concept suggested that, under the present system, the first year of a Delegate's service is largely occupied in gaining experience and in becoming "acclimated." Offsetting this was the comment that preparation for service as a Delegate can be developed through work in other A.A. service jobs in an Area.

In general, it was agreed that the key to making the two-year term a more effective instrument of service lay in developing improved techniques for utilizing Delegates' time and capacities more efficiently.

After full discussion of the subject, Delegates voted approximately two-to-one to retain the present two-year term.

I.Y.P. CONVENTIONS

For the first time in the history of the Conference, an entire panel was devoted to the subject of International Young People's Conventions and their role within the Fellowship. The discussion had been placed on the agenda at the suggestion of a Delegate.

Seven such conventions have been held to date, with the eighth scheduled to be held at Long Beach, California in August, 1965. The objectives of such meetings are stated in the announcement which had preceded the first Convention:

"To pay special attention to the blunders and successes which distinguished the history of Young People's Groups; to analyze and discuss methods and techniques particularly appropriate to Group activity and Twelfth Step work among those under forty; to provide its delegates with (information) on the application of the A.A. program to the individual difficulties encountered by young people in dealing not only with alcoholism, but also with the problems peculiar to their generation."

Delegates participating in the discussion were Ceth Mason of South Carolina; Clarence Topel of Wisconsin and Tom Allen of California. All had had specific experience with Young People's activities.

Varying Attitudes Revealed

Their comments revealed the existence of varying attitudes to-

ward Young People's Conventions.

One Delegate said that his State Conference had been held in conjunction with a "YP" Convention and that the results had been "very successful and productive."

Another Delegate said A.A.'s in his Area looked forward to having an international convention of younger members in an Area city. He said there were about 600 young members in the Area, that they are "very active A.A.'s" and that they have been found to be "more reliable than some older members," notably in work in institutions.

The third Delegate, however, said that young people in his State "have proved that they do not want to cooperate with the Area's Fall and Spring Conferences" and have never accepted invitations to be on the Conference agenda. In his Area, "it was the consensus of opinion that the name itself set up a barrier. . . and that this is a weakening in the chain of the Fellowship of A.A."

Brief discussion from the floor indicated that, in a number of Areas at least, Young People's Groups were highly regarded as cooperative. "They give a lot of zip and pep to A.A.," one Delegate noted.

Step Toward Pension Program

At a number of past Conferences, Bill W. had informally expressed the hope that it might one day be possible to establish a pension or retirement program for qualified workers in A.A.'s General Service Office. Bill had also suggested this possibility in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service."

As a result of favorable action by Delegates to the Fifteenth Conference, this possibility is much closer to becoming a reality.

The Delegates approved the recommendation of the Finance Committee of the General Service Board and the Conference Committee on Finance, meeting jointly, that funds available from "book discounts waived" be used to provide retirement income for regular employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

"Book discounts waived" refers to the policy approved by earlier Conferences of withholding a portion of the discount that had once been allowed the Groups when they purchased A.A. books. The policy was adopted in 1954 and modified in 1955, for the purpose of creating an adequate Reserve Fund to assure continuity of G.S.O. through hard times.

Reserve Fund Goal Reached

The original goal was the creation of a Reserve Fund of \$300,000. Since this goal was reached during 1964, Delegates voted that the policy of waiving book discounts should be continued but that the funds thus obtained should be made available for the proposed retirement income program. Income derived from investment of monies in the Reserve Fund will continue to be added to the Fund.

If Directors of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. should determine that additional funds for the pension program are available from their earnings, in any given year, these too will be added to funds obtained through the "book discount waiver" policy.

Adoption of a particular form of pension plan or retirement plan was left to the judgment of the General Service Board.

'Anonymity' Attractive Force

Recent widely publicized "breaks" of several A.A. members' anonymity has raised the question whether such publicity is ever justified.

The importance of the A.A. Tradition of personal anonymity to present members and to those who may turn to the Fellowship for help in the future was reaffirmed by the Fifteenth Conference following a special presentation by two Delegates, a Staff Member and one of A.A.'s oldest friends in the medical profession. By unanimous vote, the Conference re-endorsed the Twelfth Tradition as essential to the survival of A.A.'s individually and as a Fellowship.

In a thought-provoking address, Dr. Harry M. Tiebout, the first psychiatrist to support A.A. publicly, and currently a Trustee of the General Service Board, stressed the value of anonymity to present members.

"Anonymity is of course of great protective value, especially to the newcomer," Dr. Tiebout declared, "but my target today is to focus on the even greater value anonymity has in contributing to the state of humility necessary for the maintenance of sobriety."

Anonymity, thoughtfully preserved, supplies two essential ingredients, the preservation of a reduced ego and the continued presence of humility, of humbleness, he said.

Gordon LaMont, Delegate from North Dakota, summarized the opinion of his Area Committee whose members, he said, "felt that we should continue to follow the Eleventh Tradition in detail." The Committee agreed, he said, that the disadvantages of an anonymity break, even by a well-known public figure, "far outweighed" the advantages.

Cliff Morris, Delegate from Western Ontario, noted that the interest of news media in A.A. places a "great responsibility" on members. He suggested that local A.A.'s concerned with public information use the materials available from G.S.O. that are designed to prevent anonymity breaks by news media, and to prevent repetition of breaks.

INTERVIEW TIME

A new feature of Conference agenda was "Interview Time" scheduled on Thursday and running between 8:30 p.m. and 10:00 p.m. Delegates were given the choice of one or all of eight sessions held simultaneously, each manned by a member of A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Staffs and one or more Director or Trustee.

All sessions were informal and, as the name implied, they provided time in which Delegates could get answers to Group and Area problems, reactions to new procedures, reaffirmations of Traditions and principles affecting A.A. life back home. Many of the questions would have appeared in the "Ask-It Basket" had there been no "Interview Time." However, in the more informal atmosphere of these sessions, Delegates found they could devote more time to getting detailed answers without feeling that they were slowing down the Conference agenda.

Six Geographic Sessions

Six of the concurrent sessions were set up on a geographical basis; a seventh was Grapevine-staffed; another offered a continual screening of Filmstrip #2 on G.S.O. -- for the benefit of some Delegates who had not seen the filmstrip in their Areas. A Delegate was privileged to go to the session covering his Area or to attend any of the other sessions, or for that matter, to move from one session to another.

In four of these meetings, Sharing Sessions were held -- to provide broad data for G.S.O. service files, and to demonstrate how Sharing Sessions work for those who had not had them in their Areas. These were the subjects covered:

1. What can be done about members who make meetings unattractive through profanity, loud talk, etc.?
2. Should outside agencies and students be permitted to make surveys in Groups?

Typical Questions From Sessions

In all sessions, there were dozens of questions asked and discussed. These are typical:

1. How do we go about getting radio and TV time for "Ask an Alcoholic"? (G.S.O. will send details on request.)
2. How do we get doctors to a public meeting? (Get one physician on a "panel" and use this to attract others. Bring your own physician.)
3. Should "Exchange Bulletin" be published monthly? Quarterly? (Discussion pointed up fact that monthly publication might be ideal if budget permitted.)
4. How does G.S.O. handle anonymity breaks? (A letter goes to publisher or broadcaster and to A.A. involved.)
5. Should local services receive support from Groups before G.S.O.? (G.S.O. has regularly suggested that Groups give first support to Central Offices.)
6. Is it possible for letters to G.S.O. to be "cubbyholed"? How is mail handled? (Staff Member explained procedures aimed at keeping letters moving and answered within practical limits of time.)
7. Judges are sentencing alcoholic prisoners to attendance at A.A. meetings. What can we do? (Talk to judges and point out A.A.'s policy of attraction.)
8. Is "Interview Time" a useful addition to Agenda? (Unanimously: "Yes")

AREA REPORT HIGHLIGHTS

As in previous years, first-year Delegates to the Conference were invited to present brief "Area Highlights" reports on the state of the Fellowship in their sections of the U. S. and Canada. The basic theme to which they addressed themselves was that of the Conference itself, "Responsibility to Those We Serve," with the corollary theme of the influence of the Conference on the Areas.

In a summary of the "Area Highlights" presentations, Claude Millsap of Alaska said that the reports indicated that the Conference, from its inception "has had a decided influence on the growth and success of A.A."

"Areas have been guided by G.S.C. suggestions in the solution of their local problems," he declared. "Ideas acquired by Delegates attending the Conference have had a great influence on the growth of Groups, in giving a more personal feeling of relationship to G.S.O. and the Conference and in creating a wider outlook to members of our Fellowship. Before the General Service Conference, there was very little contact directly or indirectly between Groups, their members and G.S.O., leaving a vacuum in the field of much desired communication."

Has Aided Intergroup Structure

Claude said the Conference has influenced the organization of State Assemblies, conventions or Area conferences, bringing unity of purpose to the Fellowship, and has made "Responsibility to Those We Serve" the main purpose of the movement. "This in turn has brought new purpose to local Areas by the establishment of many new Intergroups and the strengthening of the older Intergroups. The Conference influence has raised attendance and participation through 'Sharing Sessions' and many other suggestions received by Delegates at the Conference."

Claude noted that Area reports had disclosed the existence of a new A.A. term, "Middle-timers," to describe the segment of the membership between newcomers and old-timers.

'Middle-Timers' Segment Active

"The middle-timers segment seems to be the most active within the total Group structure by taking on its collective shoulders most of the responsibilities of our Fellowship on a local district and state basis," Claude declared.

"However, reports suggested that in some cases more Conference influence, or information about G.S.O. and the Conference, should be given to Groups in the large metropolitan Areas as a lack of knowledge, or apathy, is prevalent. Although this was a 'minority section report,' it should be a matter of concern to our Fellowship and some steps should be taken to correct this situation."

Concern for Carrying A.A. Message

Reports suggest that the survival of A.A. "is no longer of general concern," Claude said, "but the real concern to our Fellowship is that the message be carried to the still suffering alcoholic through worldwide service, and through the Conference influence on Areas and Groups. Other reports suggest that although support is heavy on a local basis, A.A. should not forget the need for worldwide service, which involves a much larger scale of responsibility to those we serve."

Conference-approved literature has influenced many young people to come to the program earlier, thereby saving them many years of unnecessary suffering. Claude's summary pointed out,

GENERAL

AREA DELEGATES ONLY

A special feature of all annual meetings of the General Service Conference are the so-called "Area Delegates Only" sessions from which all G.S.O. personnel -- Trustees, Staff Members and others -- are excluded. These sessions are scheduled to permit the Area representatives to discuss any matters they deem important, without any possibility of being inhibited by the presence of service workers identified with the Office.

A summary of the key decisions and actions reported following the meeting included these points:

1. Bob Pritchard, representing Nova Scotia and Newfoundland, was elected by Third Legacy procedures to be Chairman of the 1966 "Area Delegates Only" meeting. The Delegates recommend to Panel 16 that they follow the same procedure allowing both old and new Panels to participate in the new Chairman's election.
2. It was recommended to the Agenda Committee that next year's meeting be held before the Conference as a whole discusses the proposed Trustees' Plan for structural changes in the General Service Board.
3. The meeting approved the continuation of "Area Highlights" reports on the 1966 Conference agenda.
4. It was agreed that Delegates have an obligation to query G.S.O. Staff Members, Trustees and Directors on matters of movementwide concern and it was felt that the new "Interview Time" sessions, as well as increased discussion with Staff Members, might be more useful in this connection than procedures used in the past.
5. It was the sense of the meeting "that all background material and history on the Trustees' ratio change, including Bill's recommendations and Trustees' opinions over the years, be made available to all members of Panels 14, 15 and 16, in order that this (material) may be fully discussed with the Groups and Areas."
6. The Delegates agreed to recommend to the Policy Committee of the Conference "that the structure of committees be changed to provide for more than the eight members now allowed."
7. The meeting also went on record as encouraging General Service Board Trustees and G.S.O. Staff Members to "bring whatever they think should be brought before the Conference without fear."
8. It was agreed to continue holding the "Area Delegates Only" meeting on the third evening of the Conference.

Claude Millsap of Alaska was Chairman of the 1965 "Area Delegates Only" Meeting.

VITAL COMMUNICATIONS

The broad scope of the services and materials available through the efforts of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board were outlined to the Delegates in one of the major presentations of the Conference. Members of the Committee who participated -- in addition to Trustee Murray Whitsett, Committee Chairman, whose report is summarized on another page -- included Fred Waters, Bob Hitchins, Janet Graves, Bayard Pope and Niles Peebles, all experts in various phases of communications.

Fred recalled Bill W.'s emphasis on "the vital importance of communications and how necessary it is to keep lines of communication open." He noted that the P.I.C. was founded and sanctioned by the Conference in 1956 "to provide interested media with a fair and accurate image of A.A. and, in so doing, 'carry the message' directly or indirectly to the millions of sick alcoholics who need our help." He described briefly the materials available for general distribution and for use by local Public Information Committees.

Bob suggested that "the fact that we in A.A. have for so long had such an excellent public image is largely due to the very fine relationship we have had with the press, television and radio." He reminded the Delegates that the Advertising Council, a business-supported organization devoted to public service, has designated the week of June 28-July 4 as "A.A. Week," as was done at the time of the 1960 International Convention. Due to this "sponsorship," many radio and television stations will be encouraged to broadcast brief messages on A.A. Bob said the P.I. Committee tries to arrange media interest in the Fellowship that will help to bring into A.A. "the countless thousands of alcoholics who need our help just as badly as we need theirs."

Janet described the widespread interest in the "Ask An Alcoholic" radio program that was heard in the New York area during the past winter and said that it had inspired the creation of similar programs in North America and overseas.

The importance of public meetings in projecting an accurate image of A.A. was emphasized by Bayard. He cited materials provided by P.I.C. to assist A.A.'s in arranging such meetings and asked the Delegates to relay local experience to G.S.O. He suggested that Delegates encourage their Areas to arrange public meetings during the week of the International Convention at Toronto.

Niles declared that A.A.'s 30th anniversary year "gives us a unique opportunity to encourage additional public recognition of A.A. in the United States, Canada and, to some extent, throughout the world." Special material about A.A. and the International Convention has been prepared, in strict accordance with the Fellowship's Tradition of "attraction rather than promotion," he said.

A portfolio of material designed to be of special assistance to the Areas in publicizing the 30th Anniversary was distributed to all Delegates.

A.A. IN COLOMBIA AND SAN SALVADOR

One of the most interesting personal presentations was the report of International Committee chairman Allan Bachman on his visit with Latin American A.A.'s in Colombia and El Salvador in the fall of 1964. Allan's trip had been planned and authorized by the Directors of A.A. World Services for the purpose of helping members in the two countries to establish effective methods of preparing and distributing A.A. literature.

Excerpts from Allan's report follow:

"Alcoholism is much more prevalent in these countries than it is in the United States. The national drink is 'agua Ardiente,' distilled from sugar, very cheap and very potent. However, many of the alcoholics drink straight alcohol. You can buy this in any Colombian drugstore for only 10¢. In San Salvador the price goes down to 4¢. Most of these people are extremely poor. In Colombia, where conditions are relatively good, the average working man makes only \$1.50 a day. In Central America, conditions are much worse. Actual hunger is widespread, and many people find that it is cheaper to drink than to eat.

"Most of the A.A. members in these countries are quite young, many of them in their twenties. When I asked about this, I was told that alcoholics do not live very long there. Fear of early death or insanity appears to be among the principal reasons for bringing people into A.A.

"In Colombia, where A.A. began five years ago, the Fellowship is growing very fast. No one knows how many members there really are, but estimates at the time I was there ranged as high as 3,000.

Airport Posters Announce Meeting

"The whole country seems to love A.A. For example, I had anticipated spending about two hours going through customs in Bogota. Instead I found a dozen A.A.'s waiting for me in an area from which the public was supposedly excluded, and they took me through customs in about five minutes without my baggage ever being opened or inspected. Posters announcing the A.A. 'Congreso' were displayed at the airport and I subsequently found them in or on buildings throughout the city.

"Bogota is a city of about a million people. The Mayor of Bogota gave a cocktail party (fruit cocktails, of course) for A.A. members the morning that the 'Congreso' opened. The Cardinal of the Roman Catholic Church spoke at the big open meeting which was held in the Opera House that afternoon. A medical officer of the Colombian Department of Defense attended subsequent A.A. meetings as the personal representative of the President. Excellent publicity appears in the local press, although violations of anonymity continue to be a problem.

"A.A. in Colombia represents a cross section of the community. Many of the members are poor and lack formal education. However, I went to one Group which had two physicians among its members, and a psychiatrist who had been sober for ten months.

"Their meetings are not too different from our own closed meetings in New York. They open with the Serenity Prayer and close with the Lord's prayer. Many of those in attendance relate parts of their stories or comment on some phase of the A.A. program, and as each speaker introduces himself by name, the announcement is greeted by a round of applause, cheers, and foot stomping.

"On one point, all members agree. They regard A.A. as their salvation. They try to live by the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. I was asked to lead a meeting on the Traditions

on a Sunday morning. Not only were the approximately 300 seats in the meeting room filled, but people were standing throughout the hall. Their 'Congreso' was attended by approximately 1,000 people, although no one can really say because there was no registration and, of course, no registration fee.

"I believe that A.A. is in a very healthy state in Colombia and that it will continue to grow rapidly.

* * *

"For the A.A. members in El Salvador and the neighboring countries of Guatemala and Honduras, A.A. is truly a new way of life. They never seem to tire of carrying the message of their recovery to others. Many of the Groups hold meetings every night in the week. On Sunday, because automobiles are a rarity, Groups in San Salvador rent buses and drive out in the country to spend the day with Groups which are in process of formation.

Meetings Are Huge and Long

"Some of their meetings are huge and they go on for hours. I attended and spoke at the Third Anniversary meeting of one Group in San Salvador. It was held in the Law School auditorium and I estimate that approximately 2,000 people were present. It started at nine o'clock on a Sunday morning and continued until 2:30.

"A.A. means much more than sobriety in the lives of these people. It is a great social force, as well. At the time I was there, A.A. was only three years old in Guatemala but it had developed to the point where they had forty-five Groups and about thirteen hundred members. Some of the older members in San Salvador had gone to Guatemala and spent about two weeks carrying the message on the radio and through meetings. The same procedure was followed a year later in Honduras. I was told that some of the Salvadorians planned to visit Nicaragua next and I am sure that there is now a substantial A.A. membership in Nicaragua.

"I left these countries with a sense of awe and with some humility. To see the joy and dedication shining from the faces of sober alcoholics who have found the means of recovering from the obsession to drink was the most heart-warming and inspiring experience in the lives of these people - the grace of God."

I am responsible.

When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible.

Yo soy responsable.

Quando cualquiera, dondequiera, extiende su mano pidiendo ayuda, quiero la mano de A. A. siempre esté allí. Y por eso: Yo soy responsable.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

All Delegates had an opportunity to obtain specific information -- anonymously, if desired -- by placing questions in a special container, the "Ask-It Basket." Following are answers to 1965 questions of movement-wide interest.

ANONYMITY

What is the experience regarding an A.A. clergyman breaking his anonymity at the public level?

One Delegate said that a talk to such a clergyman by several A.A. members had been effective. Another suggested sending a copy of G.S.O.'s letter on anonymity breaking along with a copy of Bill's article "Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous." Another suggested telling the offender that while he might not be hurting himself, he is harming other members and the Fellowship as a whole.

Is it a break of anonymity for me to tell the supervisor in my plant that I am an A.A. member and would like to help with any employee alcoholic problem there?

No, it was felt that this would not be an anonymity break since it does not involve revealing A.A. membership at the public level.

FINANCE

May a member of A.A. leave money in trust with the income and/or principal in the sum of \$100 annually paid, by the trustees to the Rochester Central A.A. Office until the fund is exhausted?

The G.S.O. practice is not to accept bequests of any kind. A Staff Member pointed out that the 1959 Conference reaffirmed this policy of declining all bequests from A.A.'s or non-A.A.'s whether the bequests are lump sums or \$100 annuities. One Delegate asked if \$100 left in memoriam would be accepted. The answer is yes, once.

Is the Financial report sent to each Group?

Yes. This material is contained in the "Early Bird" edition of the Conference Digest. It will also appear in the Highlights edition that goes to each Group, and of course, in the full Conference Report.

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Should G.S.R.'s be allowed to vote for their Area Delegate when they only show up for the election?

A Staff Member noted that according to the Third Legacy Manual, G.S.R.'s representing their Groups are part of the Assembly and therefore should be entitled to vote. Delegates with similar problems in their Areas said that G.S.R.'s were allowed three absences or so, after which they are replaced. Many Delegates felt that if G.S.R.'s didn't attend a certain percentage of announced meetings they should not be allowed to vote.

Is Herb going to compute the average age of Delegates again?

This was done. The average age is 10.2 years.

Explain the "Conference Mailbox" mentioned in Hazel's report.

Hazel said the "Mailbox" was sent to Delegates about a month ago. It is a compilation of Delegates' reports to G.S.O. on their activities. This material will be mailed to all Delegates and Committee Members about every three months, in the belief that this kind of sharing will be helpful to them.

Are Conferences becoming too long and draw out? Wouldn't it be more effective and less costly to keep it to three days or possibly a weekend?

One Delegate said it would be unfair to go home with less information considering the growth of the Conference and Committee work. Another Delegate said the problem is to hold the Conference to six days and make it as productive as possible. Pressures of past Conferences well show the need for the number of days we now use. Some Delegates suggested a break in the middle of the Conference might be helpful. Perhaps the trip to Bedford Hills could be made then. It was pointed out that this would not be feasible, since Lois and Bill would not be home. Bill attends the A.A. Conference and Lois attends the Al-Anon Conference. While there might be an interruption in continuity with a break in the middle of the Conference, the idea might also have merit. This will be considered further.

What should be done to stimulate interest of G.S.R.'s in metropolitan areas?

A Delegate from a large metropolitan area said that this situation is handled in his Area by scheduling more District meetings, running Assembly meetings on a sharing basis, working in Groups through Committee Members and showing the G.S.O. filmstrip. There is no quick answer, but interest is continuing to increase steadily.

What is the sense of the Conference and Areas in regard to Delegates being paid for expenses other than the \$100 towards transportation to New York?

Generally, Delegates felt this was a matter for the Area to decide. One said he believed all Delegates realized their expenses would exceed the amount provided by G.S.O. for hotel and meals. If additional money was offered he accepted. The consensus was that it is all right to accept extra money. Another Delegate suggested that this might be mentioned in the "Exchange Bulletin" or GV, so that all Areas might be aware of this situation.

Does Bill W.'s last name have to be deleted everywhere, including the Conference Agenda?

It is assumed that everyone knows who is meant when they see the name Bill W.!

Would it be possible to list the themes of past Conferences once a year in an issue of the "Exchange Bulletin"?

Yes, this can be done. We will try to carry this item in the "Exchange Bulletin," or an Interim Report.

At the 14th G.S.C., agreement was reached that it is generally not advisable to accept proxy votes from regular Groups at A.A. Assembly meetings. Has the use of proxies at Assembly meetings been reduced, as a result of this agreement?

Eight Areas reported by a show of hands that there had been a reduction in the use of proxies.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Has anyone informed the Conference just how much the change in structure will cost in dollars and cents?

Five additional Trustees will be named if the Plan is adopted. The additional cost will be about \$3200 to \$4500.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE

What do Conference Members think of filmstrips? How about another one of G.S.O.?

A show of hands revealed that a great majority of Delegates favored the filmstrips now in use. Herb explained that it was originally planned to produce these on a two-year basis. We hope to start another one shortly. Herb said it may be that G.S.O. should do one every year, despite the cost of almost \$3500 per filmstrip.

Would it be possible to get copies of the A.A. Growth Chart?

Yes. It will be published in the "Exchange Bulletin." If it is planned for use at local Conferences, a blow-up of the Chart can be done locally or, G.S.O. can have it reproduced and perhaps send it out with literature displays.

In the beginning of the Fellowship, there was a lot of interest in institutional A.A. How can we revive this interest, especially in the penal institutions?

The Staff Member who currently corresponds with institutions said that there is no need to revive interest, it is very much alive. There are about 550 hospital Groups, some 700 prison Groups and over 600 institutional sponsors listed with G.S.O. This reveals a great deal of interest. Older A.A. members are already familiar with this work and so are newcomers when they learn what service opportunities are available. It is up to us to tell newer A.A. members about institutional work and interest them in becoming active.

What are "special projects" mentioned in Midge's Conference Report?

Midge said this referred to material other than general correspondence, i.e. various G.S.O. bulletins sent to the membership, reprint material, preparation of various reports, and so forth.

I receive many requests for material from high school and college students on the historical background of A.A. Do we have such material?

Yes. We suggest "44 Questions and Answers," "This is A.A.," and "A.A. Helpful Ally."

What does G.S.O. suggest on the problems arising from A.A. members wanting to form an A.A. Big Brother movement for ex-inmates in institutions? Is there a difference between a Big Brother and a sponsor?

Many such groups are registered at G.S.O. and are listed in the Institutions Directory. There was controversy at the beginning since Big Brothers aimed to provide jobs, clothing, etc. However, this type of help to parolees was eliminated. They provide a service similar to that of Institutional Committees in larger metropolitan areas. One Delegate said that one institution in his area has a clearing house for prisoners about to be released. Information is sent to a Big Brother in the parolee's neighborhood. The newly released man is met and introduced to a Group. In a sense the Big Brother becomes his sponsor. Another Delegate defined a sponsor as a man whom one can confide in and talk about one's alcoholic problem. No material gain is received or

given. If Big Brothers provide more than this kind of guidance, he felt, they may be stepping out of the bounds of A.A.

What is the experience regarding the activity of narcotic addicts and office holding in A.A. prison Groups?

In one Federal penitentiary, the A.A. Group is called the "open door" Group. The Warden believes all inmates can use this program. It is made clear, however, that only A.A. members may hold office. Most Delegates felt that only A.A. members should hold office in A.A. prison Groups, although narcotic addicts may attend if they feel they can benefit by being observers. Attention was called to an article pertinent to this question in the January 1965 "Grapevine."

GRAPEVINE

Has publishing an index of "Grapevine" articles ever been considered?

An index of yearly articles is carried in each December issue of the magazine. This was begun in the December 1962 issue and will be continued.

GROUP AFFAIRS

Ann's report indicated that a Lone Member could be an alcoholic who did not want to attend Group meetings. Isn't this dangerous? Most of us had to attend meetings to realize that alcoholism is no respecter of persons.

Ann explained that no one is registered as a "Loner" if there is a Group in the area. Occasionally a person is put on the mailing list to receive "Loners Meeting" and other help because of a family situation that makes it impossible to attend meetings. However, he or she is not listed in the World Directory as a Loner.

Is it advisable for two struggling Groups located close together to consolidate?

The motivation in forming two Groups is important. Often such separation is because of personality difficulties. Much of the growth of A.A. has been because one faction of a Group started a separate Group on account of dissatisfaction with the way the Group was run. If two Groups maintain good relations, then their separation may not be a bad thing. Both can try to build up their memberships. The answer really depends on the reason for the separation.

Members of Gamblers Anonymous were asked to speak at an A.A. open meeting. An old-timer refused to let them speak because there were newcomers present who had come to hear about alcoholism. What is the opinion of Delegates on this?

One Delegate who had both problems felt that both obsessions are similar. Both are illnesses, he said, noting that gamblers could gain a great deal from attending A.A. meetings. In general the Delegates felt that G.A. members should not participate in A.A. meetings, or hold office in an A.A. Group. Bill's article on "Problems other than Alcohol," reprinted in the January 1965 "Grapevine," was suggested as a guide in this situation.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

What is the opinion concerning exclusive ex-convict meetings?

A Delegate said a group of parolees and ex-parolees held a closed meeting, with parole officers also in attendance. It was run on the lines of an A.A. meeting and they wanted to be called an A.A. Group. The Delegate explained that as an A.A. Group they should open their doors to anyone with an alcoholic problem and should not keep it exclusive. They did this and are now functioning successfully as an A.A. Group. One Delegate said that the individual ought to integrate himself into society as a whole. No professional qualifications are needed. Another Delegate said that in his Group there was no trouble with convicts attending. There had been many meetings on the "inside." Sponsors met parolees when they were released, took them to meetings and they were welcomed in the local Groups.

How is a closed meeting kept closed?

It was suggested that this responsibility be given to the Group secretary.

What is the opinion of a situation in which one Group maintains an answering service and another uses the service without contributing financially?

One Delegate said that the main consideration is to help the sick alcoholic. If it means one Group carrying the expense, so be it. However, the Group could remind the non-contributing Group occasionally that it ought to chip in. This was generally felt to be the best way to handle this problem.

LITERATURE

How many copies of both editions of the "Big Book" have been printed to date? How many translations?

First edition: (1939-1954) -	303,000
Second edition: (1955-1963) -	262,000
Norwegian composite book:	3,000
Finnish composite book:	5,000
Afrikaans composite book:	3,000
French composite book:	2,900

In addition, many thousands of copies have been printed in Spanish, but figures are not available.

Could a pamphlet entitled "Keep coming back" be considered for slippes?

Question referred to Literature Committee who felt such a pamphlet would not serve A.A.'s primary purpose, and so did not recommend its preparation.

Is the new pocket-size "12 and 12" available yet?

No. It will be "unveiled" at the Toronto Convention in July.

P.I.C.

A doctor in A.A. asks: "Does A.A. know of anything new pertaining to the physical aspects of alcoholism?"

Dr. Jack said that much research is being done, but mostly in "bits and pieces." While this research may be relevant the difficulty is that most of it is not related to what happens to people. There is little that is of real significance to A.A. Hope that much more will be done that has relation to people.

What opinion does P.I.C. have regarding anonymity breaks by the ex-Governor of West Virginia and the Governor of Iowa? Since their anonymity has already been broken at the public level, why not capitalize on the break to advertise A.A.?

The Chairman of P.I.C. said that the consensus of the P.I. Committee is that these breaks are regrettable. These Governors as well as the magazines and newspapers carrying their stories have been sent the usual letter explaining our Tradition of anonymity and its importance to A.A. (Two Delegates who knew the Governors personally, briefly outlined the Governors' A.A. backgrounds.) Another Delegate who has run for public office explained his experience in coping with opponents who tried to use his alcoholism against him. The Delegate from West Virginia said that members in his Area considered the ex-Governor's story a success story. However, he personally thought it was in disregard of the anonymity Tradition. Another Delegate said that A.A. actually gains from such anonymity breaks because many prospects believe all A.A. members are low bottom drunks. When they see that prominent people have the same problem, they are more apt to join.

Color Film: "Bill's Own Story"

A highlight of the Fifteenth Conference was the premiere showing of a one-hour color film, "Bill's Own Story," in which the surviving Co-founder of A.A. and his wife, Lois, discuss informally Bill's last drinking days and the historical events leading up to the formation of the first A.A. Group.

Only Bill and Lois appear in the picture, which was filmed at their home, "Stepping Stones," in a suburb of New York. Speaking extemporaneously, Bill retells the story of his experience while drinking, of his recovery, of his meeting with Dr. Bob S. in Akron and of their call on Bill D., the third man to recover through what has now come to be known as the A.A. program.

Interspersed throughout Bill's narrative are comments by Lois on her reaction to Bill's drinking and to the first years of his sobriety.

The film was made by Arthur Daley, a professional motion picture producer, on an extremely modest budget. Herb Morse told the Delegates that, "by using every trick in the book to keep costs down," Art had been able to make the picture for approximately 10% of what the usual one-hour color film of this type would cost.

Since no G.S.O. budget allocation has been made for "Bill's Own Story," the film must pay for itself, Herb said. Currently, prints will be rented for \$35 per week or fraction thereof and each exhibitor will assume the cost of routing the print to the next screening point. Initially, Groups wishing to book the film are limited to one week's rental.

Use of the film is limited to A.A. meetings only.

A.A. World Services, Inc./G.S.O.

(Herb M., Chairman)

A.A. World Services, Inc. is the corporation that is responsible for setting up and controlling the budget, for the employment of G.S.O. personnel, and for the publishing and distribution of Conference-approved books and pamphlets.

A.A.W.S. is a membership corporation that is "owned" by the General Service Board (Trustees) in that the voting members are the Trustees. They elect seven Directors who are responsible for A.A.W.S. direction. Two of these Directors are Trustees; three are A.A.'s who are selected for their experience and availability; a sixth is the Staff Coordinator; the seventh -- who is A.A.W.S. Chairman -- is the Manager of General Services.

G.S.O.'s administrative group is made up of the Manager of General Services; six Staff Members (one of whom is Coordinator); Supervisors of Accounting, of Clerical-Steno, of Shipping, of Records; and the Archivist. There are 39 full-time and 3 part-time employees at G.S.O.; these totals do not include Grapevine personnel.

PUBLISHING: Sales of A.A. books and pamphlets continue to increase and so reflect the growth of A.A. In 1964, sales were \$282,640, which was 3.9% ahead of 1963. The publishing operation paid its own share of overhead and contributed \$35,000 to the General Fund to help support other services. While sales ran ahead of the previous year, it was also true that the distribution of some pamphlets fell off. To correct this -- and to encourage Groups to stock a variety of pamphlets -- A.A.W.S. authorized the preparation of a special pamphlet describing available pamphlets and offering a new wire rack for Group literature tables. Initial orders for these racks have been encouraging.

In '64, A.A.W.S. authorized free distribution of 153,000 pieces of literature with an actual value of \$5,641 plus shipping costs. This literature went out to new Groups and to the public as part of our information service. Of this amount \$1,600 was represented by non-English literature and the balance in English.

During the year, A.A.W.S. authorized Allan Bachman as Co-Chairman of the International Committee to help set up literature distribution centers in Colombia, South America, and San Salvador in Central America, to be operated by A.A.'s in these countries. For this purpose, extended credit to the extent of \$1,000 was set up for each center. It is expected that these centers will eventually become self-financing and will be the nucleus for service centers for their areas.

Distribution of literature, tapes and miscellaneous items in 1964 totalled nearly 1,500,000 units.

SHIPPING: During 1964, the Shipping Department set new records. Al Cryan, supervisor, kept 7 full-time and 3 part-time employees busy handling 75,127 incoming mail items and sending out 244,960 mail items (including "Exchange Bulletins"). Book and pamphlet orders were filled with the shipment of 40,253 packages to all parts of the world. Addressograph work was heavier than ever before, involving 20,482 stencils. More than 700,000 copies of mimeographed material was produced for all departments.

Additional space was taken on the 12th floor for live inventories and where other departments find useful and easily accessible space for files, exhibits, etc.

CLERICAL/STENO: In September, we added about 50% to the effective work space for this department and for Records and Clerical/Steno. Including Kleina Jones, Supervisor, the Clerical/Steno Department has 14 people on dictation, filing, typing, switchboard. The International Convention and the extended 1965 General Service Conference added to the work of an already busy department. Last year, more than 1,200 visitors were shown through the department.

Shipped During 1964.

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	32,509
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions	12,107
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	3,763
Alcoholics Anonymous - Spanish Ed.	1,687
	50,066

PAMPHLETS

This is A.A.	134,611
44 Questions & Answers	108,054
Is A.A. for You?	153,621
Partners in A.A.	23,075
Young People & A.A.	43,408
A.A. for the Woman	45,975
Memo to an Inmate	22,573
A.A. in Prisons (New)	1,788
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	28,301
Alcoholism the Illness	61,191
The Alcoholic Husband	59,686
The Alcoholic Wife	38,745
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	21,501
A.A. & the Medical Profession	29,125
Tranquilizers, Sedatives & the Alcoholic (Disc.)	32,759
Sedatives, Stimulants & the Alcoholic (New)	22,377
A.A. Tradition - How it Developed	19,394
A.A. Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism	59,187
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	38,933
Fortune Reprint	24,691
Good Housekeeping Reprint	33,550
The Third Legacy Manual & Concepts	2,938
Inside A.A.	22,767
The Fellowship of A.A.	58,180
G.S.R. Folder	15,920
Foreign Translations	79,470
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	26,348

Total Pamphlets Shipped 1,208,168

MISCELLANEOUS

Wallet Cards	217,573
Parchment Scrolls	1,721
How it Works	52,535
Tapes of A.A. Talks	400

ACCOUNTING: Under the supervision of Dennis Manders, three full-time and one part-time employees recorded and acknowledged 12,320 contributions and processed 11,880 orders in 1964.

RECORDS: Last year established some new records for numbers of new Groups and number of changes of addresses, etc. The Records Department handled all correspondence involving these changes and worked with the Steno Department and with the Staff in making acknowledgements. Most of the time there are four in the Department, one a Varitype operator. Around "World Directory" time, this department works far into the night under the able direction of Mary Ann Dolan, acting Supervisor. In addition to this Directory, the department prepares and publishes the two institutional directories (hospitals and prisons) and many special lists.

ARCHIVES: This office is under the guidance of Nell Wing who also serves as Bill's secretary. Here are records from the beginning of A.A., including Group histories, early books and pamphlets, Conference reports, photographs and film prints. With the Fellowship entering its 30th year, our Archives have proved to be a rich source of interesting material about our growth.

G.S.O. REPORTS

International Committee

(Allan B., Co-Chairman)

The International Committee, a subcommittee of the G.S.B. Policy Committee, was established in the fall of 1963 to meet a need for a wider sharing of A.A. experience in connection with the development and growth of A.A. Groups outside the North American continent.

Prior to the formation of the International Committee, except for requests made to A.A.W.S. for permission to translate A.A. literature, almost all relations with overseas A.A. had been handled by the A.A. Staff Members assigned to that field. There was no clear line of communication to the Board of Trustees.

The committee reviews the progress, problems and needs of overseas A.A., its growth and experience, and makes recommendations as to the sharing of service experience with foreign countries. Recommendations regarding literature translation needs have been an important function of the committee. A policy for translation of literature in a country where A.A. is new and a literature need is indicated was established last year and has been followed. A beginning has been made, for example, in printing literature in Italian, and in Portuguese for the new Groups in Brazil.

Responsibility For Own Services

One of the first decisions of the International Committee was to encourage foreign countries to assume responsibility for their own service needs. The last Conference approved a tentative proposal to hold a workshop for Spanish-speaking countries in New York City. It was contemplated that these comparatively new A.A. members would learn enough about all phases of G.S.O. publishing and service activities to return to their homes and set up literature distribution centers, publishing centers and, eventually, their own General Service Offices. However, while this idea was still in process of investigation, we received and accepted an invitation to be represented at a national convention of A.A. in Bogota, Colombia. As a result arrangements were made for the establishment of literature distribution centers in Medellin, Colombia, to handle all requests for A.A. literature from South America, and in San Salvador, El Salvador, to handle all literature requests from Central America. Both centers are now engaged in the publication of A.A. literature at prices much lower than anything with which we could compete. In Colombia, the center has already published its own edition of the Big Book, and a number of the pamphlets. In El Salvador, the pamphlets are being published. In both places, plans are under way for the establishment of general service offices.

G.S.O. Information Activities

(Beth K.)

During 1964, the General Service Office received 4,356 inquiries. These were from alcoholics, family and friends of alcoholics, students, student nurses and nurses, teachers, doctors, clergymen, librarians, social workers, state commissions on alcoholism, public health agencies, industry and authors.

The two A.A. displays for use at professional meetings were shown at twelve national professional conferences during 1964. A special "single use" display was prepared and distributed for use in other informational situations.

We received 3,659 domestic and 1,200 foreign press clippings in 1964 which mentioned Alcoholics Anonymous. Approximately ten anonymity breaks came to our attention and appropriate material on the anonymity Tradition was sent to the media and individuals involved.

Three cases of apparent misuse of the A.A. Directory were handled in a similar manner.

G.S.B. Public Information Committee

(Murray W., Chairman)

Cooperation with Media

A.A.'s fourth Annual "Report to the Public" was released on July 12, 1964. This report gave information about Groups, members, growth outside North America, relations with other agencies in the field of alcoholism, special services to alcoholics, services to non-members and the 1965 International Convention in Toronto celebrating our 30th Anniversary. The report also contained the Conference-approved statement of A.A.'s position in the field of alcoholism.

With careful consideration of the anonymity tradition, P.I.C. cooperated in the filming of certain A.A. sequences for a film on non-professional organizations in the field of alcoholism rehabilitation. The film is one of a series sponsored by the U. S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare.

Cooperation with other Agencies

The Chairman of P.I.C.:

Spoke at the National Council on Alcoholism Conference in April, 1964.

Attended the annual meeting of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs in Portland, Oregon in September, where he participated in a panel on relations of other agencies with N.A.A.A.P., presenting A.A.'s position of cooperation but not affiliation.

Members of P.I.C. and Staff Members met for the fifth time with the Executive Committee of N.A.A.A.P. during their annual meeting in New York City in January, 1965.

Statistics

The P.I. Committee approved the use of the term "more than 90 countries" in our literature to describe the scope of A.A.

30th Anniversary

A subcommittee was formed from the P.I. Committee to take responsibility for publicity on the 30th anniversary year, and to work closely with Roy Madden, chairman of the Working P.I. Committee in Canada.

The Advertising Council will announce in their May-June Radio TV bulletin "A.A. Week" as June 28 - July 4. Spot announcements of different lengths and a slide and table card have been prepared for mailing to radio & TV stations and regional and national networks. They will go out in May.

A letter was sent to all local Public Information Committees informing them of A.A.'s activities during the 30th Anniversary Year and suggesting things they may do to help. Updated P.I. kits were mailed to all local P.I. Committees and Delegates.

Approximately 3500 letters went to newspapers, radio and TV stations and magazines in the United States, Canada and some overseas, offering facts and information about A.A. during this 30th Anniversary year.

G.S.B. Policy Committee

(Tom S., Chairman)

During the past year committee discussions have centered largely around Conference Agenda subjects -- with specific recommendations being made to the Board for its approval. Suggestions for nonalcoholic speakers for the 30th Anniversary Convention have also been thoroughly discussed.

The International Committee is the only subcommittee of Policy Committee -- all others are full Committees of the Board.

A.A. Overseas

EUROPE

(Ann M.)

In 1950 there were 23 European Groups listed in the "World Directory." Today there are 410 Groups with 7,243 members.

Years and experience have shown that our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions can work in any society when they are once understood.

GERMANY: Germany is planning its Service Board and Service Office. This April all German-speaking Groups are meeting to discuss future plans. At the annual European Round-Up held in Wiesbaden in 1964, 80 Germany members were present at a business meeting to discuss, in particular, the problems and activities of German-speaking members in Germany, Austria and Switzerland.

BELGIUM: Groups in Belgium are divided linguistically between Flemish and French. Most are Flemish. Their literature distribution center, Algemeen Dienst Bureau, has prepared a Flemish translation of the Big Book with the cooperation of A.A.'s in Holland and Belgium.

Their Flemish magazine, 5 Voor 12 carries a listing of all Groups. The Liege Intergroup now serves 25 French-speaking Groups.

HOLLAND: There has been a reorganization of A.A. in Holland, which began as an outgrowth of the Municipal Bureau of Alcoholism in Amsterdam. It has taken some years to establish A.A. as an independent entity. A recent report indicates that this is now underway.

The newly revised Translations Order Blank lists 16 pamphlets available in French, as well as the Big Book and "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."

In addition service material is available in French, Polish, German and Hungarian, including material designed for the Lone Member.

"How A.A. Starts and How it Grows," material designed to be helpful to starting Groups, is available in Flemish, Italian and German.

There are 14 pamphlets in Finnish, plus the composite book (abridged material from the Big Book, "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," and "A.A. Comes of Age"). There are three pamphlets in Norwegian, plus the composite book, four in Swedish, three in Italian, three in German, plus the Big Book and the Twelve Steps from the book, "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."

ENGLISH-SPEAKING AND FAR EAST

(Eve M.)

A.A. has become well established in: Australia, New Zealand, Africa (South Africa), United Kingdom, Ireland:

AUSTRALIA: Local services have long been developed in Australia, and there are Central Offices in Brisbane, Melbourne, Sydney, Adelaide, and Perth. Each of these also publishes a news letter which is widely distributed within each area.

NEW ZEALAND: A New Zealand Conference has started, with three delegates from four area assemblies, and a steering committee elected to be responsible for services in New Zealand.

REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA: A.A.'s in South Africa established a General Service Committee for all the Republic many years ago. The Big Book was published by them in Afrikaans and they assumed all financial responsibility for it, and for the distribution of all their literature. Recently they have also assumed responsibility for the publication of Bantu literature, with temporary financial assistance from G.S.O.

RHODESIA AND ZAMBIA (previously known as Northern and Southern Rhodesia) have developed similarly. Intergroup services in Kitwe, and a Service Information Committee in Salisbury, are available now for the two countries.

For the balance of Africa, there have been initial contacts and Lone Members in Ghana, Kenya, Liberia, Nigeria, Mozambique, Chad, and the Congo. So far, no Group activity has developed, other than in Morocco and Libya, where there have been occasional Armed Forces Groups.

ENGLAND was the first country outside the United States to establish its own publishing company, and a General Service Board responsible for it. A development committee, recently formed by the Board in Great Britain for establishment of public information activity, has done an outstanding job, and they plan to hold a General Service conference in the future.

SCOTLAND has two intergroups, in Edinburgh and Glasgow.

NORTH IRELAND maintains a central office in Belfast.

IRELAND: Dublin has maintained a central office for many years, and "The Road Back" has been one of the most consistent and lively publications throughout A.A.

ASIA: There are several areas (where A.A. had a toehold through American and English travelers and Armed Forces personnel) which are now developing nationally: Japan, Korea, Ceylon, and India.

JAPAN: There is a Group of Americans who live in Tokyo as well as scattered Armed Forces Groups. There is a Japanese Group in Mukogawa.

INDIA: Bombay has been the keystone of Indian A.A. Originally one large Group, it is now broken into four smaller Groups, including discussion Groups. They have recently instituted an Intergroup Committee. This committee is responsible for publication and distribution of pamphlets translated into Hindi and Marathi.

The Group in Delhi is still functioning. A new Group was formed in Calcutta two months ago and has already grown to 14 members.

CEYLON: There has been considerable activity and sudden growth in Ceylon this past year. There are now four Groups, and members are attempting to establish an A.A. Center. They have translated "Is A.A. for You?" into Singhalese.

KOREA: There have been Lone Members and an occasional Armed Forces Group in Korea in the past. Through the activity of Sgt. Z., the A.A. message has recently been carried to Koreans. A minister, Rev. Choi, became interested in A.A. He, through the help of one of the chaplains in Seoul, printed "Is A.A. For You?" in Korean, and through the financial assistance of A.A.W.S., has also translated and printed "This Is A.A." in Korean. They report 200 A.A. members.

G.S.O. REPORTS

A.A. In Institutions

(Ann M.)

The continuing need is for A.A.'s who will interest themselves in carrying the message to institutions. Directories of Hospitals and Prison Groups were prepared in November, 1964 and mailed to all these Groups as well as the 82 Institutional Committees and 636 Institutional Sponsors.

The count at that time was:

547 Hospital Groups with a membership of 12,913.
686 Prison Groups with a membership of 27,353.

Exchanges of tape recordings and of institutional publications are important ways in which such Groups share their experience. Directories indicate when such exchange is permitted by institutional personnel.

Chaplains continue to be valuable allies within the correctional institutions, acting as sponsors and advisers to inside Groups and providing help and liaison with administrators. Other nonalcoholic institutional personnel have given continued support, encouragement and cooperation.

Conference Secretary's Report

(Hazel R.)

Growing awareness of responsibility and an increase in the use of effective tools for sharing A.A.'s service message keynoted General Service Conference activities during the past year.

Emphasis is now being placed on the functions and responsibilities of A.A.'s interested in serving as part of the General Service Conference Structure. Past Delegates, Committee Members and G.S.R.'s have assisted in this development.

The role of the Delegate, Chairman and all Assembly members is becoming a year round activity.

Delegates and Chairmen Active

Delegates and Chairmen have been active in their vital role of keeping the two-way flow of communication open between the General Service Board, G.S.O., the Grapevine and their Committee Members and G.S.R.'s. They are using film strips, traveling displays, interim reports, sharing sessions, district meetings, monthly newsletters, little assemblies, full assemblies, breakfasts, tape recordings, service material, A.A. literature, inventories and lots of footwork and gasoline to include all A.A.'s -- oldtimers, middle-timers and newcomers.

So many valuable experiences have been reported that the "Conference Mailbox" was developed and will be mailed quarterly to Delegates and Committee Members.

Tape Service

(Beth K.)

Over the past two years, G.S.O. has made tape recordings available. These tapes are listed at \$2.50 a tape (speed 3 3/4, 7 inch, 2 track).

Five are personal recovery talks and three are special talks which include the recovery story of our co-founder, Bill.

During 1964, 399 tapes were sold.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

(Tom W., Editor)

"Grapevine" circulation is at the highest figure in our twenty year history; since January, 1963, the increase has been 9 percent, or an average of 4.5 percent each year. The circulation of the February, 1965 issue was 43,355 paid subscriptions plus about 2,000 single copy sales.

The "Grapevine's" second year "in the black" was 1964. The Corporation now has cash reserves equal to unearned income, and the Board is studying proper ways to use possible net profit left over from future operations.

Tom White was appointed editor of the "Grapevine" during the Conference last year. There have been no other changes in Staff.

There have been a number of minor changes in the format of the magazine during the year, and our order blank and postpaid return envelope (inserted in two issues) have been revised. We are studying further changes.

The "A.A. Exchange Bulletin"

(Midge M.)

The purpose of the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" is to share A.A. news throughout the Fellowship, and it is our only means of regular communication with all Groups. At present the mailing list for the Bulletin is 19,500.

For the first time bulk subscriptions were made available to Groups at the special yearly rate of \$2.50 for ten copies. About seventy-five Groups took advantage of the opportunity and ordered over 1,200 copies. The offer has been repeated in the April-May Bulletin.

To save on mailing costs there will be six issues of the Bulletin in 1965, but the amount of news and information will be increased through expanded issues from time to time.

The Bulletin has recently been used effectively to sample movement-wide experience on a variety of subjects: Group operations, meetings, women in A.A. etc.

Lone Members

(Ann M.)

About 599 Lone Members were registered at G.S.O. as of spring, 1965, 332 of these outside the United States and Canada. These are men and women who for various reasons, mainly because of geographical location, are not in a position to attend meetings.

Special material that has been prepared from the actual experience of A.A.'s who have been able to stay sober without Group activity is available at G.S.O. and is sent to each Loner as he registers, as well as a supply of pamphlets, copies of the "Exchange Bulletin," and "Loners Meeting," a Bulletin which goes out monthly to all Loners.

Internationalists

(Eve M.)

Sea-going A. A. members registered at G.S.O. as members of the Internationalist Group now number 322. G.S.O. serves them through preparation of an annual listing and periodic distribution of a "Round Robin" letter in which their correspondence is shared.

Nominating Committee of G.S.B.

(Austin MacCormick, Chairman)

The Nominating Committee met quarterly throughout the past year, with Austin MacCormick serving as Chairman.

This Committee maintains a file of candidates to be drawn on as vacancies occur on the General Service Board, and on A.A. World Services, Inc., and the Grapevine, Inc., boards.

Some of the Committee's actions during the past year include:

1. Compiled, reviewed, and accepted written "composition, scope, and procedures" which outline purpose and function of their committee. This was accepted by the General Service Board.
2. Reviewed resumes of the new Class A Trustee candidates. Recommended election of Dr. Travis Dancy, to fill Class A vacancy on the General Service Board. This election was accomplished at January meeting following review by Conference Committee on Trustees and mail poll of Delegates.
3. Accepted, with great regret, resignation of Ivan Underwood, Class A Trustee, to take effect following the Annual Meeting of the General Service Board in April.
4. Recommended that Vincent Dole, M.D. be accepted as nominee and be elected as a Class A Trustee to fill vacancy at the Annual Meeting of the General Service Board, following presentation to the General Service Conference in April.
5. Reviewed all resumes and recommended that all Class B Regional Trustee candidates received from West Central and Northeast Regions be presented for election of one Nominee from each region during the 15th Annual Meeting of General Service Conference.
6. Reviewed electoral procedure in preparation for participation in election during the 15th Conference.

7. Reviewed resume of Class B Trustee candidate from Manitoba, Canada, and recommended Tom Breen be added to slate for election in April following presentation to Conference for disapproval, if any.

8. Recommended slate of Directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. to be elected at Annual Meeting in April by Members of A.A. World Services, Inc.

9. Recommended following be accepted as Nominees for Trustees of the General Service Board and approved for election at the Annual Meeting of the General Service Board in April, following their presentation to the General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

CLASS A TRUSTEES

Leonard Harrison
Austin MacCormick
Hon. John Murtagh
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard Smith
Dr. Tiebout
Prof. Harrison Trice
Dr. Vincent Dole
Dr. Travis Dancy

CLASS B TRUSTEES

Mary Bernson
Don Goddard
Eugene Kelley
Murray Whitsett
Jim Masterson
D. Bruce Mansfield
Northeast Region Nominee
West Central Region Nominee
Tom Breen

10. That the following officers of the General Service Board be approved for election at the April Quarterly Meeting of the General Service Board, after being presented to the General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any.

Chairman - Dr. Norris
1st Vice-Chairman - Bernard Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman - Gene Kelley
Treasurer - Archibald Roosevelt
Secretary - Murray Whitsett

Coordinator's Report

(Midge M.)

All Group correspondence is now handled by six Staff Members. Correspondence is the primary concern and largest part of a Staff assignment. Each problem is researched, if necessary, and an individual reply is prepared, with emphasis on the Twelve Traditions.

Each Staff Member has a basic assignment--such as Conference, Coordinator, Public Information, Institutions or Overseas--and she also has a geographic area in the U. S. and Canada for Group and individual correspondence. These assignments are rotated regularly--one or two years--so that each Staff Member eventually has a working knowledge of every Area and every phase of service.

To promote sharing of experience in assignments, all letters and answers are collected in a folder and circulated daily. Bi-weekly and special Staff meetings are held for discussion of problems or suggestions for new projects.

Among the 1,200 visitors to G.S.O. during the year were A.A.'s with families and friends from many countries outside the U. S. and Canada as well as visitors to the World's Fair and members coming to New York on business. Our translators serve as interpreters for our non-English-speaking members and friends.

(Continued on page 32)

Service Material

(Midge M.)

From time to time a need develops, through questions in correspondence, for specific G.S.O. suggestions or help on a particular subject. When this need becomes clear by repetition of questions on this same subject, information and Group and Area experience is gathered and prepared by the Staff for distribution.

Service material thus prepared (often in mimeographed form) is of substantial help to Staff Members in answering correspondence. It has the added advantage of providing a uniformity in reply.

Service material does not appear on the literature Order Form because these special-purpose items are not sold.

Periodically the Staff reviews service material for updating and revision. The most recent piece to be completely rewritten is "Suggestions for Local Conferences, Conventions and Area Get-togethers."

With A.A. growing rapidly outside the United States, translations of "Intergroup" and "Central Office" material are helpful to A.A. Groups that are beginning to "carry the message" in other countries and who wish to avoid pitfalls occasionally encountered in "new" A.A. areas.

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie,

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership. Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilber Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,
Bill
(Signed in full)

WGW/nw

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

OBSERVERS' REPORTS

Scandinavia

The only Observers' reports presented to the Fifteenth Conference covered the Scandinavian countries and were made by Hart Sonju who, although a resident of the U.S., has for many years assisted in the development of A.A. in the Nordic countries. Hart, the Observer for Norway, incorporated in his comments a written report from Ralph Bugli, currently the Observer for Sweden.

Norway

The future looks bright for A.A. in Norway and there is apparent unity of the Fellowship there. Although the World Directory registers 76 Groups with more than 1,300 members, Hart said it was possible that there may be an additional ten to 20 unreported Groups and that total membership may approximate 3,000.

Hart noted that, after some experimentation with "non-Traditional A.A.," Norwegian members are now adhering closely to A.A. tradition. Service needs of the movement are being met through facilities supervised and administered by (1) A National Advisory Board (seven A.A.'s and two non-A.A.'s) comparable to the General Service Board in its functions and (2) A National Secretariat of seven to nine members composed of volunteers whose work is comparable in objectives to that of the General Service Office in New York.

Norwegian A.A.'s have translated a substantial amount of Conference-approved literature, the most recent achievement being the production of a Norwegian edition of "The Third Legacy" pamphlet.

Sweden

Swedish A.A. is now growing slowly but solidly, Ralph indicated in his report. There are now nearly a dozen Traditional Groups with a combined estimated membership of approximately 200 persons (including an allowance for unreported Lone Members).

A noteworthy recent development has been an increase in the number of women alcoholics who have turned to A.A. for help and a historic milestone was reached this year when a women member became the first of her sex to lead a meeting of the largest Stockholm Group.

Swedish A.A.'s now have a small but active Central Committee to encourage better communication with all A.A.'s in the country and with nonalcoholics who are concerned with the problem of alcoholism. Service material and Conference-approved literature provided by G.S.O. is being translated and used enthusiastically. Although many problems face A.A. in Sweden, due to the activities (now apparently declining) of another movement that functions in a non-Traditional manner, progress in "carrying the message" is made.

Denmark

In a brief summary of the situation in Denmark, Hart noted that there are now only two Groups, both in Copenhagen, that can be classified as part of the Fellowship. As in Sweden, the activities of a competitive movement have hampered the growth of Traditional A.A. "It is hoped that faith in A.A. and a broad view of A.A. worldwide by our friends in Copenhagen will initiate growth and progress in Denmark," Hart said.

Literature Committee of G.S.B.

(Dave B., Chairman)

Activities of the Literature Committee of the General Service Board in 1964/65 included:

Approved the final draft of "Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic."

Reviewed several pamphlets which have been used for the G.S.R. and recommended new material be prepared.

Recognized need for a study guide for beginners and newcomers meetings. Prepared an outline for study by the Conference Literature Committee.

Reviewed all comments of Conference Literature Committee members on the revision of the "Partners" pamphlet, and recommended a new start be taken, suggesting Question and Answer technique. The new draft will be reviewed by the Conference Literature Committee.

Received updated material from John Park Lee to include in the Social Work reprint, for use until a new pamphlet, "A.A. and the Social Worker," may be prepared.

Received a suggestion for a new pamphlet "A.A. in the Community." Such a pamphlet would contain material on what can be expected from A.A. in the community as well as what A.A. cannot do. The Committee looked with favor on such a pamphlet and requests that the Conference Literature Committee consider this.

General Service Board

(Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman)

The General Service Board meets quarterly, on the last Monday of April, July, October and January. The following summarizes typical actions of the Board, in accordance with recommendations of the 1964 Conference.

The Board:

1. Approved the wording, "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature," to appear under the A.A. seal on all Conference-approved literature; also approved the wording, "This has been reprinted with the approval of the General Service Conference," to appear on non-G.S.O. material distributed with the approval of the Conference.
2. Appointed a subcommittee of the Finance Committee to study a pension plan for G.S.O. employees.
3. Approved, for presentation to the 1965 Conference, a proposal for financing a pension plan for G.S.O. employees from book discounts waived by the Groups, and from other sources.
4. Approved publication of a new "small format" edition of the book, "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," to have a minimum list price of \$3.00.
5. Approved consideration at the 1965 Conference of a possible three year term for Delegates.
6. Approved consideration of "A.A. Family Groups" at the 1965 Conference.
7. Approved a policy of permitting A.A. publications to reprint material from "The A.A. Grapevine" freely, with appropriate credit to "The Grapevine" in a style and format approved by "The Grapevine."

Spanish-Speaking Groups

(Waneta N.)

The A.A. population explosion in Spanish-speaking countries has made necessary the services of one Staff Member and two full-time translators.

The Grupo Concepcion in San Salvador celebrated its 4th Anniversary on November 8, 1963. One hundred seventy-three Groups were represented by members from El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras and Costa Rica. More than 3,500 were present. The complete program was broadcast.

Spanish-speaking members become service-minded almost immediately and call on G.S.O. for public information material and guidance in "carrying the message" through newspapers, radio, and to doctors and clergymen.

A.A. in Mexico has grown more slowly, but members are beginning to open Intergroup Offices and in the near future will assume the responsibility of printing their own literature. Permission has been granted the Intergroup Office in Mexico City to print pamphlets until a General Service Board is established and may wish to become the publishing agent. There are approximately 35 Groups and 650 members.

A.A. in Spain and the Canary Islands is growing steadily. The province of Guipuzcoa, Spain, has set up an A.A. Coordinating Office in San Sebastian. The Groups of San Sebastian meet there at the present time.

Service material available in Spanish includes "Public Meetings," "Cooperation But Not Affiliation," "Dangers in Linking A.A. To Other Projects," "Conventions or Conferences," Public Information and Intergroup Material.

G.S.O. Spanish Bulletin

G.S.O. publishes a mimeographed bulletin in Spanish every two months, in which is reprinted pertinent material from the "Exchange Bulletin" and "Grapevine," along with other pertinent information.

We emphasize that when we speak of sobriety in our literature and letters, it means "total abstinence." There had been some confusion on this point in a few Spanish-speaking areas.

Our Spanish-speaking Groups are very young and cannot afford a great deal of literature, so we send them a limited amount free of charge.

Efficient G.S.O. Growth

How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel -- In 1945 there was one employee for each 98 Groups. Today, one employee serves each 294 Groups.

During the past twenty years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$314,000 for services charged to the Group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 71%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per Group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$15.60.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Employee	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1964	11,752	40	294	26.70	171

ADVISORY ACTIONS

REPORTS FROM CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

The following reports were presented to the Conference by Committee Chairmen and their acceptance by the Delegates constituted Advisory Actions of the Conference. All Conference Committees suggested changes in Committee procedures that were incorporated in the report of the Conference Committee on Policy.

OTHER AGENCIES

The Conference Committee on Relations with Other Agencies Recommends:

1. That Delegates establish lines of communication with Directors of tax-supported and voluntary Alcoholism Programs in their areas.

2. That the Conference reaffirm the comment on question #16 in the pamphlet "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" and request publication of the following in the A.A. Grapevine:

"Experience shows that A.A. Groups and Intergroups or Central Committees should not operate or manage these ventures. Individual A.A.'s frequently set up such related facilities, being careful not to use the A.A. name in solicitation, advertising and publicity. These ventures are usually set up on a nonprofit basis, incorporated under the charitable and educational laws of the state and excluding 'Alcoholics Anonymous' from their names.

"Hospitals and rest homes and other community rehabilitation aids bear the same relationship to A.A. Groups, Intergroups or Central Committees as do any other outside agency. With full cooperation of the Groups in the community they are used for referral, provided A.A.'s Tradition of non-endorsement and non-affiliation is made clear.

"Since these ventures are separate from the Fellowship, it is advisable that they operate under names which do not link them to A.A. -- under names other than '12th Step House,' 'Alanon House', etc."

3. That in accordance with past procedure, the "World Directory" should not be made available to other organizations because of its confidential nature.

4. That the title of the Conference "Committee on Relations with Outside Organizations" be changed to the Conference "Committee on Relations with Other Agencies."

Jim Hawkins of Alabama was elected Co-Chairman.

CONVENTION

The Convention Advisory Committee:

1. Approved reports on the preparation of a book entitled "A.A./30" being prepared for sale at the Convention.

2. Disapproved a suggestion that Convention Funds be used to defray expenses incidental to attendance at the Convention by certain early A.A. members but suggested that Area Committees might be interested in such projects.

3. Received, and added to the existing file of bids for a 1970 International Convention, an invitation to hold such a meeting in Colorado.

POLICY

The Conference Committee on Policy recommends:

1. That Committee members continue to be selected by lot, geographically and that this drawing be conducted by the Chairman of the Policy Committee of the G.S. Board at the January Policy Committee meeting. Any Delegates' names not received by that date will be added to Committees as received.

2. That Delegates assigned to Committees before the Conference then be advised of their Committee assignments by the Conference Secretary and given the opportunity to refuse assignment. Delegates will also receive at this time "Composition, Scope and Procedures" for all Conference Committees and names of Chairman and other members of their Committee.

3. That Committees include all Delegates as active voting members and that "advisers" be discontinued.

4. That this year's "advisers" become full-pledged Committee members immediately.

5. That Co-Chairmen be elected at final meeting of each Conference Committee.

6. That Co-Chairmen be elected by written ballot by all members of a Committee.

7. That Co-Chairmen become Chairmen of their Committees immediately following each Conference.

8. That Committees be as uniform in size as possible.

9. Suggested that Committee members can communicate with each other through requesting secretary to duplicate letters from members and mail to all Committee members.

10. That Committee "workshops" be continued.

11. That all G.S.R.'s receive the Group mailings from G.S.O.

12. That all Area Assemblies at which Delegates are elected be held prior to December 31.

The Committee redefined its "Scope" as follows: "That the Conference limit and define this Committee's responsibilities to cover only matters of policy pertaining to the Conference itself and such other matters as may properly be placed before it."

Ed Myers of Washington was elected Co-Chairman.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The Conference Committee on Report and Charter:

1. Recommends use of the "Early Bird" edition of the Conference Digest to help Delegates in preparing their talks to their Groups following the Conference.

2. Disapproves a proposal to bind past Conference Final Reports for sale to Delegates, Committee Members and Groups.

3. Agreed that members of this Committee will return rough drafts of the Conference Report to G.S.O. one week from time of their receipt.

Cora "Tommy" Dayton of Connecticut was elected Co-Chairman.

LITERATURE

The Conference Committee on Literature recommends that:

1. A new G.S.R. pamphlet be prepared following the suggestions outlined by the G.S.B. Committee.
2. The pamphlet, "A.A. and the Community," be prepared as outlined to date, with additional emphasis on what A.A. cannot do.
3. That the suggested guideline for conducting "Newcomers Meetings" be used as service material, adding the preamble and slogans, and that at some future time a pamphlet might be considered.
4. No pamphlet for the "slippee" be considered, as it would not be helpful in our primary purpose.
5. In all future pamphlets, and in revisions, an effort be made to avoid "alphabetical abbreviations" and to spell out such abbreviations as G.S.R. and A.A.W.S. "in the interests of clarity and education."
6. No glossary of "A.A. terminology" be prepared, since it would be difficult to have absolute uniformity in terminology, and perhaps not advisable.

The Committee approved the draft of "A.A. in Hospitals" and members agreed to have their suggestions in the mail to G.S.O. by May 15. The Committee approved the draft of the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group," with the specific recommendation that some emphasis on the value of our Tradition of placing principles before personalities in our Group life, be incorporated. Additional suggestions and corrections to be incorporated in the final draft are to be received by G.S.O. by May 15.

The Committee also recommended to the Policy Committee of the Conference that "communications would be improved if the secretary of the Committee: (a) Acted as a focal point coordinating Committee correspondence, (b) 'Sifted' material received from Committee members in order to eliminate 'personal factors' in material relayed to other members, (c) distributed a newsletter to Committee members from time to time."

The Committee further recommended to the Policy Committee that "members of the Conference Committee be assured of their right and obligation to communicate directly with any General Service Board Literature Committee members."

Ray Free, Nevada, was elected Co-Chairman

GRAPEVINE

The Conference Committee on The A.A. Grapevine:

1. Suggested that Area Committee members be appointed to inform members on Grapevine developments. (A need was shown for some action on the part of all interested to indicate the many uses of the Grapevine in Twelfth Step work.)
2. Suggested that an article, instead of promotional inserts, would be more effective in interesting individuals and Groups in obtaining subscriptions for Loners, Institutional Groups, foreign members and friends of A.A.
3. Approved unanimously the present contents of the magazine, expressing favorable opinion of its continuing improvement.

4. Recommends that the Grapevine use the services of Area Committees in promoting the sale of the Grapevine at the Group and individual level.
5. Recommends an article or series of articles be published pointing out the value of individual subscriptions.

George Dvorak of New Jersey was elected Co-Chairman.

FINANCE

The Conference Committee on Finance reports as follows:

The Committee elected Robert Daly of Southern Minnesota as Co-Chairman to start serving as Chairman immediately following the Conference. The Committee also reaffirmed the recommendations and actions taken at the Joint Conference and Board Committee meeting as follows:

1. Approval of the Board Finance Committee Report.
2. a. That the policy of book discounts being waived by Groups, established by 1954 and modified by 1955 Conference actions be continued.
b. That the Reserve Fund which has reached \$307,775.26 as of 12/31/64 receive no more funds from book discounts waived.
c. That for the year 1965 and subsequent years, funds resulting from book discounts be waived together with funds, if any, determined each year by the Board of Directors of the Grapevine to be available for such purpose, be used to provide retirement income for regular employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. pursuant to a pension plan or retirement plan in form as may hereafter be adopted by the General Service Board.
3. Approval of the recommendation "That the system of quarterly acknowledgments of Group contributions be adopted by all the Groups in the United States and Canada.
4. Approval of G.S.O. and Grapevine Budgets.
5. Approval of two motions and three recommendations stemming from the Finance Workshop were reviewed and all five approved unanimously. They are as follows:
 - a. That the present method of choosing Conference Committees be retained, i.e., drawing from the hat at the Conference.
 - b. It was recommended that in future years, Conference Committee Co-Chairman be elected at the last meeting of the Conference Committee rather than the first, to provide a greater length of time for the Committee members to make a choice.
 - c. That it be reaffirmed that the Co-Chairman start to serve as Chairman immediately following the Conference.
 - d. That with respect to the Finance Committee, that the members serving this year as observers be incorporated as voting members immediately and that the sense of the motion be that the same recommendation be given to the Policy Committee to effect all Conference Committees (effective immediately 1965).
 - e. It was recommended that communications between Conference committee members and, if desired, with members of the General Service Board Committee members be improved and facilitated through the Conference Committee Secretary and Conference Committee Chairman throughout the year.

ADVISORY ACTION

AGENDA

The Conference Committee on the Agenda recommends:

1. That Area Highlights be retained for next year's Conference, with recommendation that diversified topics be given to incoming panel Delegates in order to avoid repetitious presentations.
 2. That the present Chairman retain his chairmanship until the following Conference, at which time the elected Co-Chairman will take over.
 3. That committees include all Delegates as active voting members and that alternates or observers be dispensed with.
 4. That the present method of choosing committee members be retained.
 5. That the Policy Committee and the Board of Trustees inform the Agenda Committee members of actions taken on proposed agenda subjects. A brief reason be given for rejections, if any.
 6. That subjects approved for the agenda by Policy and Board be made available to Delegates, through the Interim Report, following the January Quarterly Meeting.
 7. As the above recommendations came as a result of the Workshop discussion, this committee recommends that the workshops be retained.
 8. That the following items be considered by the Policy Committee of the Board for next year's agenda:
 - a. Consideration be given to a review of the exclusion of a candidate for nomination of a Class B Trustee within a 75 mile radius of the New York area.
 - b. The Delegates' only meeting be held before any consideration of the 5-Year Trustees Plan.
 - c. A presentation, discussion and guidance be given on the topic of bringing back the "Old Timers" to participate in Group and area activity.
 - d. Consideration be given to arrange "Interview Time" at next Conference by Staff territorial assignments.
- Jim Barber, E. Missouri, was elected Co-Chairman.

ADMISSIONS

The Committee:

Recommends, after reviewing the request for an additional Delegate for Indiana, that such request be granted, effective with the 1966 Conference, on the basis of population, growth and communications needs in the Area.

Clarence Topel was elected Co-Chairman of the Committee.

TRUSTEES

The Conference Committee on Trustees:

1. Approved the report of the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board (See Page 27) and recommends its approval by the Conference.
2. Agreed, following careful review, that the procedures for electing Class B Regional Trustees, continue to be satisfactory.
3. Agreed that, if two States in an eligible Region nominate the candidate to be a Regional Trustee, a Delegate from each state may make a three-minute presentation in support of the candidate.

Jack Mohr was elected Co-Chairman.

FINANCIAL

1965 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1965 operations of the General Service Office, exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine, is as follows:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, NET INCOME FROM SALES AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	Income	Expenses	Net Income	Net (Deficit)
G.S.O.	\$300,000	\$316,700*		\$(16,700)
(Contributions)				
A.A. World Services	181,500**	134,100	47,400	
(Publishing)				
General Service Bd.		29,000		(29,000)
(General Fund)****				
	<u>\$481,500</u>	<u>\$479,800</u>	<u>\$47,400</u>	<u>\$(45,700)</u>
Estimated Net Income	\$1,700***			

*Including cost of General Service Conference.....\$ 33,100

**Based upon GROSS INCOME from Sales (totaling \$296,600) of
33,650 Books - "Alcoholics Anonymous"
13,000 Books - "12 Steps & Traditions"
3,800 Books - "A.A. Comes of Age"

Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

***Exclusive of Reserve Fund Investment Income of..\$ 11,500

****Board Meetings, P.I.C. Expense, Special Projects

Contributions of \$300,000 are expected for 1965, \$15,990 over the 1964 total. This is a conservative increase of 5.6%.

Expenses of G.S.O. for 1965 have been budgeted at \$2,730 over the 1964 expenses. Additional printing economies, shipping, labor savings, and a number of other economy measures are taken into account in arriving at the 1965 expense total.

'A Million Dividends'

(Continued from page 10)

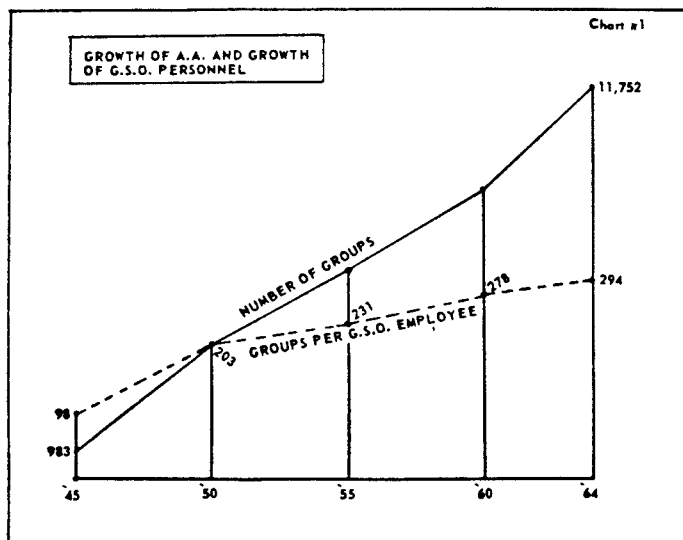
this was phenomenal. Here were lecturers, very much on the intellectual side, and they were paying tribute to an organization created by laymen, by people without any professional training, without an intellectual approach -- in a real sense -- to the problem of alcoholism. I have never since lost my interest in Alcoholics Anonymous. I continue to have a growing admiration for work that is being accomplished in this field, and to me it is rewarding. I have given just a little and, like yourselves, I have gotten a million dividends. The beauty of the philosophy that underlines this organization is as real to me, as a non-alcoholic, as it is to you. I think I have been a better person because I have seen in your program a philosophy that I held before but that I never perceived, as realistically and as meaningfully, as I have since I have been with you."

Coordinator's Report

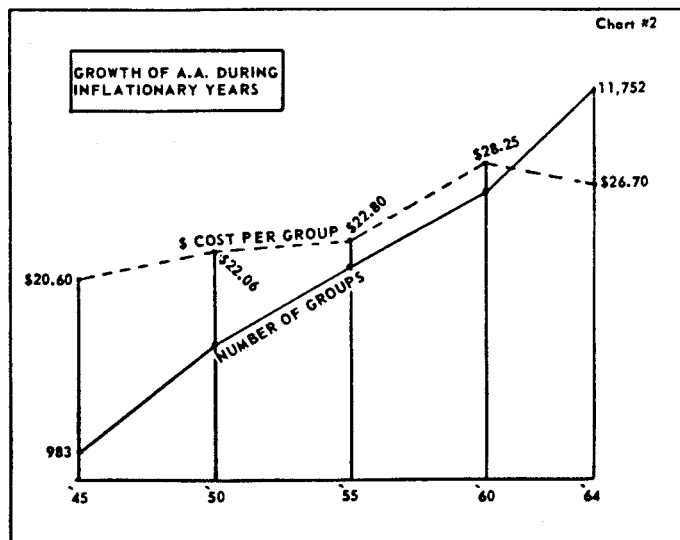
(Continued from page 27)

The Fall "Open House" was very well attended by Delegates, Committeemen and G.S.R.'s as well as by many members from Connecticut, New Jersey and New York.

Thirty Areas invited Staff Members to participate in their activities during the past year. This does not include the many invitations accepted by Herb, Dr. Norris and the Trustees.

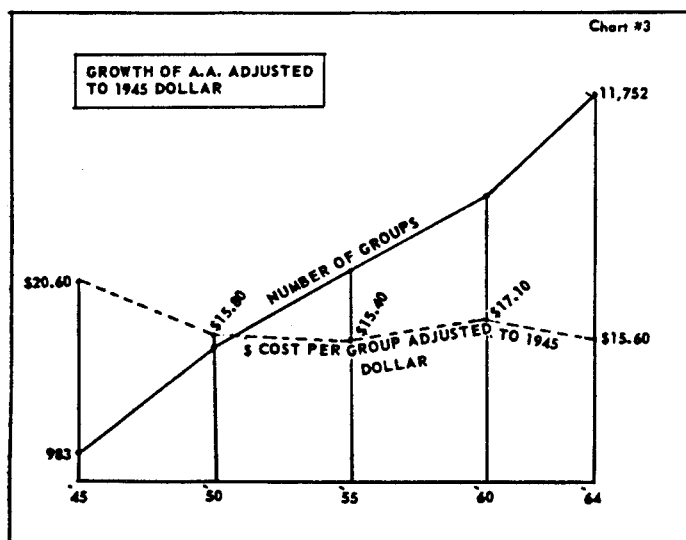


1. (Above) There are 12 times as many Groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 294 Groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



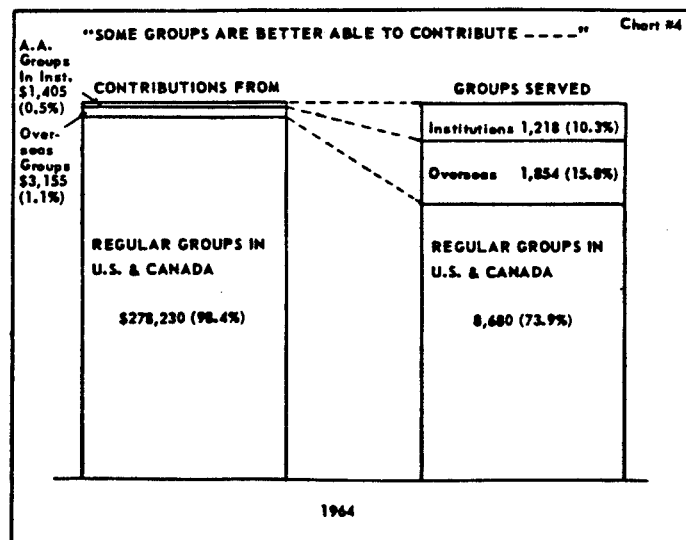
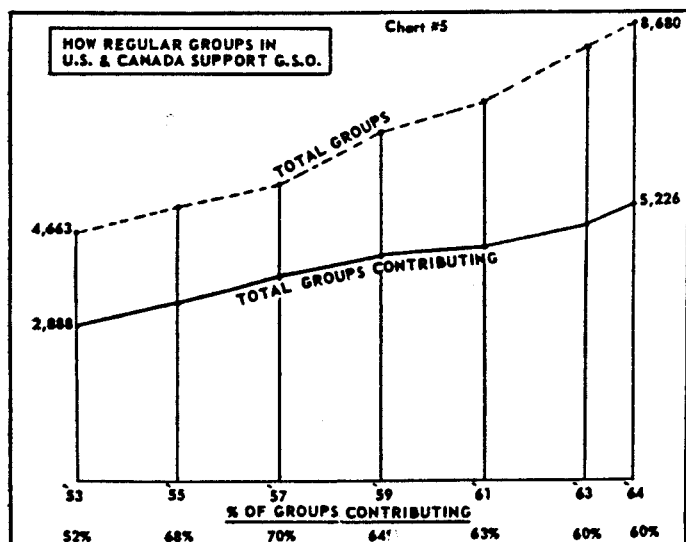
2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1964, the cost of living increased 71 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per Group to \$26.70 in 1964 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 30 percent.

GROWTH & MONEY AT G.S.O.



The continuing efforts of the General Service Office to provide increased service to alcoholics while holding costs down were dramatized in a special presentation to the Conference by Herb Morse, General Service Manager. Herb made these points, which are illustrated by graphs in a four-page folder prepared for the presentation.

3. (Left) Today's dollar is worth considerably less than the 1945 dollar. When the cost of service per Group is translated in terms of the 1945 dollar, the service cost today is actually \$15.60, compared with \$20.60 in 1945.



4. (Above) Some Groups are better able to contribute to the support of world services than others. For example, 18.5 percent of all Groups are overseas but they account for only 1.1 percent of total contributions. Institutional Groups comprise 10.3 percent of the Group total but account for only 0.5 percent of total contributions.

5. (Left) In 1964, the number of Groups contributing to the support of world service was 5,226, only 60 percent of all regular Groups in the U.S. and Canada. This ratio -- the same as in 1963 -- was actually lower than the average for the ten preceding years.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

EXHIBIT A

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1964

	December 31, 1964		December 31, 1963	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$107,944	\$ 79,630	\$133,176	\$ 55,575
Accounts Receivable (including \$13,545 advance to Convention Operating Fund)	26,976	2,252	9,986	2,096
Inventories	66,900	536	84,500	980
Prepaid Expenses	8,978	7,171	9,628	6,978
Furniture and Equipment (net)			1	2,000
CONVENTION FUNDS	33,551		14,421	
RESERVE FUND	307,776		276,388	
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>\$552,125</u>	<u>\$ 89,589</u>	<u>\$528,100</u>	<u>\$ 67,629</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	14,232	2,452	24,866	2,339
Unearned Income — Prepaid Subscriptions		67,639		64,356
— Convention Fund Receipts	33,551		14,421	
— Other	619		619	
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>\$ 48,402</u>	<u>\$ 70,091</u>	<u>\$ 39,906</u>	<u>\$ 66,695</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	211,806	934	203,495	(21,049)
Income (Expense) for Year (Exhibits B and C)	(15,859)	18,564	(3,259)	21,983
Collection of Advance to A.A. Grapevine, Inc.			11,570	
RESERVE FUND	307,776		276,388	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>\$503,723</u>	<u>\$ 19,498</u>	<u>\$488,194</u>	<u>934</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION				
World Service Office (Note B)	\$ 11,045		\$ 11,007	
Publishing (Note A)	130,025		118,839	
General Fund (Notes A and B)	54,877		81,960	
Reserve Fund	307,776		276,388	
<u>Total — as above</u>	<u>\$503,723</u>		<u>\$488,194</u>	
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUNDS, DECEMBER 31, 1964	Reserve Fund	Convention		
Cash	\$ 16,325	Guarantee	Operating	
Preliminary Expenses		\$ 8,682	\$ 21,617	
U.S. Treasury Obligations	279,244		10,817	
Corporate Bonds — U.S.	9,356			
Mortgage Debentures — Can.		5,980		
Accrued Interest	2,851			
Less: Due General Fund			(13,545)	
<u>Totals — at cost</u>	<u>\$307,776</u>	<u>\$ 14,662</u>	<u>\$ 18,889</u>	

() Denotes Red Figures.

NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS: In the attached financial statements amounts under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CONVENTION GUARANTEE FUND, which was established in 1962 to underwrite a possible deficit in receipts from the International Convention to be held in Toronto in 1965. To the extent not so used, it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

The CONVENTION OPERATING FUND, which was established in 1964 with the advance sale of registrations and tickets for the purpose of recording the fiscal operations of the Convention.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1964

	<u>1964</u>	<u>1963</u>
INCOME		
Sales	\$282,641	\$272,109
Less: Cost of Products Sold	79,948	80,478
Royalties on Books	28,790	27,658
Gross Profit from Sales	173,903	163,973
Contributions	284,009	270,275
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>457,912</u>	<u>434,248</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	227,758	205,728
Rent	32,044	30,282
Exchange Bulletin	12,351	11,514
World Directory	16,914	18,406
Other Service Office Printing	6,797	6,386
Shipping and Mailing	32,621	30,797
Other Office Expenses	44,508	36,901
Insurance and Taxes	18,425	16,011
Professional Services, Gift	12,242	15,263
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	11,827	11,628
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	12,937	12,778
P.I.C., Travel	5,817	5,193
General Service Conference	32,851	30,348
Foreign Literature Aid	3,220	3,988
Film Strip and Display Boards	3,459	2,284
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>473,771</u>	<u>437,507</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSES)	<u>(15,859)</u>	<u>(3,259)</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
World Service Office	(\$ 29,962)	(\$ 13,807)
Publishing	46,186	39,403
General Fund	(32,083)	(28,855)
RESERVE FUND CHANGES		
Balance, January 1	\$276,388	\$245,912
Book Discounts Donated	20,383	19,832
Investment Income (Net)	11,005	10,644
Balance, December 31	<u>\$307,776</u>	<u>\$276,388</u>
() Denotes Red Figures		

(continued from foot of Exhibit A)

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

NOTE A — After transfers of \$35,000 in 1964 and \$45,000 in 1963 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B — Advances of \$30,000 in 1964 and \$14,000 in 1963 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years. Advances to the Group Contribution Fund in these and prior years remaining unpaid at December 31, 1964 totaled \$126,765.

NOTE C — Included in the accounts of the Convention Funds are amounts totaling U. S. \$31,598, converted from Canadian \$34,350 for the purpose of the financial statements.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

EXHIBIT C

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1964

	1964	1963
INCOME		
Subscriptions, Sales and Interest	<u>\$171,076</u>	<u>\$163,430</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	30,302	25,493
Severance Pay		1,451
Printing	39,998	37,745
Mailing	17,253	15,388
Rent	5,253	5,220
Telephone	1,150	1,226
Office Supplies and Expense	2,194	1,536
Office Cleaning	500	514
Total	<u>96,650</u>	<u>88,573</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	27,372	24,813
Stationery and Supplies	1,527	1,657
Rent	5,253	5,220
Telephone	898	872
Office Expense	1,894	1,945
Bad Debts	351	223
Conference	137	165
Selling Expense	2,055	3,446
Postage	3,111	3,110
Office Cleaning	500	514
Total	<u>43,098</u>	<u>41,965</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	2,562	2,363
Legal and Accounting	2,400	2,500
Taxes	4,222	4,113
Meetings	611	498
New Equipment and Depreciation	2,969	1,435
Total	<u>12,764</u>	<u>10,909</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>152,512</u>	<u>141,447</u>
NET INCOME	<u>18,564</u>	<u>21,983</u>

1965 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and bulk sales \$175,000.00

Estimated expenses 165,150.00

Net income 9,850.00

G.S.B. FINANCE AND BUDGETARY COMMITTEE

(Archibald B. Roosevelt, Chairman)

Operations of A.A.'s General Services resulted in a deficit of \$15,550 in 1964 as compared with a deficit of \$3,250 in 1963. (Exclusive of Reserve Fund appreciation.)

The publishing activities of A.A. World Services, Inc. earned \$46,400, an increase of \$7,000 over 1963.

Group contributions in 1964 were \$284,000, approximately 10.5% less than the cost of office and Conference expenses. The sum of \$30,000 was transferred from the General Fund to

the Group Fund to make up this deficit of \$29,950. As against our estimated budgeted expenses, contributions were \$6,000 short. Our total operating expenses (Group, General Fund, Publishing) were 3.3% over the budgeted amount as projected by the Budget Committee.

Book discounts donated and invested income resulted in a net addition to the General Service Board Reserve Fund of \$31,390 for the year 1964.

SUGGESTED SHARE OF 1965 BUDGET

Based on an estimated budget of \$316,700 and on the 1964 membership, the share of each state and province for the year 1965 is apportioned in the following schedule.

U.S.	1964 Membership	State or Province Share	U.S.	1964 Membership	State or Province Share
Alabama.....	1,250	\$ 2,740	Ohio	8,200	\$ 17,985
Alaska	262	575	Oklahoma.....	1,240	2,720
Arizona	1,214	2,660	Oregon.....	1,071	2,350
Arkansas.....	815	1,785	Pennsylvania.....	4,679	10,265
California	22,838	50,025	Rhode Island	379	830
Colorado	1,353	2,970	South Carolina.....	1,039	2,280
Connecticut	2,292	5,025	South Dakota	766	1,680
Delaware.....	357	780	Tennessee	1,067	2,340
District of Columbia	1,365	2,995	Texas	6,929	15,200
Florida.....	3,809	8,355	Utah	710	1,560
Georgia	1,577	3,460	Vermont.....	303	665
Hawaii	297	650	Virginia.....	2,281	5,000
Idaho.....	407	890	Washington.....	2,154	4,725
Illinois.....	10,388	22,790	West Virginia.....	384	840
Indiana.....	2,398	5,260	Wisconsin.....	2,334	5,120
Iowa	1,752	3,840	Wyoming.....	272	595
Kansas.....	1,512	3,315	Commonwealth of P.R.....	476	1,045
Kentucky.....	923	2,025	TOTAL for U.S.A.....	128,498	\$281,765
Louisiana.....	1,660	3,640	CANADA		
Maine	470	1,030	Alberta.....	1,059	\$ 2,325
Maryland	1,546	3,390	British Columbia	2,029	4,450
Massachusetts.....	3,862	8,470	Manitoba	1,193	2,615
Michigan.....	5,379	11,800	New Brunswick.....	445	975
Minnesota	4,646	10,195	Newfoundland	129	280
Mississippi	667	1,465	Nova Scotia.....	632	1,385
Missouri.....	2,731	5,990	Ontario.....	4,809	10,550
Montana	532	1,165	Prince Edward Island.....	233	510
Nebraska.....	603	1,320	Quebec.....	4,211	9,240
Nevada.....	769	1,685	Saskatchewan	1,111	2,435
New Hampshire	433	950	Yukon Territory.....	62	135
New Jersey.....	3,107	6,815	Northwest Territories.....	15	35
New Mexico	857	1,880	TOTAL for CANADA	15,928	\$ 34,935
New York.....	9,083	19,920	TOTAL for U.S.A. & CANADA	144,426	\$316,700
North Carolina	2,560	5,615			
North Dakota	500	1,095			

1964 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

U.S.	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	60	39	65%	\$ 2,941.67	1,250	\$ 2.36
Alaska	26	18	69	1,540.13	262	5.88
Arizona	91	53	58	3,006.40	1,214	2.48
Arkansas	56	29	52	1,611.50	815	1.99
California	969	816	84	37,842.67	22,838	1.66
Colorado	69	49	71	3,021.24	1,353	2.23
Connecticut	120	69	58	4,313.50	2,292	1.88
Delaware	17	10	58	611.00	357	1.71
Dist. of Columbia	35	20	57	1,841.50	1,365	1.35
Florida	228	134	59	8,492.20	3,809	2.23
Georgia	107	73	68	3,298.78	1,577	2.09
Hawaii	26	13	50	823.00	297	2.77
Idaho	30	17	57	567.00	407	1.39
Illinois	517	178	34	8,670.38	10,388	.83
Indiana	184	94	51	4,796.00	2,398	2.00
Iowa	91	54	59	4,023.00	1,752	2.30
Kansas	86	58	67	2,713.00	1,512	1.69
Kentucky	84	56	67	4,270.79	923	4.63
Louisiana	95	47	50	3,203.83	1,660	1.93
Maine	47	30	64	1,006.50	470	2.14
Maryland	101	67	66	4,345.39	1,546	2.81
Massachusetts	189	113	60	6,636.04	3,862	1.72
Michigan	329	199	61	14,050.73	5,379	2.61
Minnesota	256	129	50	7,943.50	4,646	1.71
Mississippi	37	30	81	1,647.56	667	2.47
Missouri	142	76	54	3,697.47	2,731	1.34
Montana	47	33	70	1,013.19	532	1.90
Nebraska	60	44	73	2,288.19	603	3.79
Nevada	49	25	51	1,249.00	769	1.62
New Hampshire	28	13	47	808.75	433	1.87
New Jersey	244	137	56	6,707.00	3,107	2.16
New Mexico	52	29	56	1,735.84	857	2.03
New York	479	293	61	21,854.56	9,083	2.41
North Carolina	169	91	54	4,000.30	2,560	1.56
North Dakota	41	23	56	764.00	500	1.53
Ohio	437	327	75	13,227.20	8,200	1.61
Oklahoma	77	61	79	5,315.77	1,240	4.29
Oregon	96	69	72	3,004.49	1,071	2.81
Pennsylvania	293	174	59	9,058.02	4,679	1.94
Rhode Island	29	16	55	1,925.90	379	5.08
South Carolina	70	45	64	2,070.25	1,039	1.99
South Dakota	49	26	53	1,398.40	766	1.83
Tennessee	67	34	51	1,410.16	1,067	1.32
Texas	351	287	82	16,922.22	6,929	2.44
Utah	56	29	52	915.98	710	1.29
Vermont	26	14	54	828.79	303	2.74
Virginia	121	67	55	4,927.00	2,281	2.16
Washington	175	104	59	5,608.58	2,154	2.60
West Virginia	28	21	74	1,072.00	384	2.79
Wisconsin	162	119	73	4,842.55	2,334	2.07
Wyoming	23	16	70	734.90	272	2.70
Commonwealth of P.R.	27	13	48	489.00	476	1.03
TOTAL for U.S.	7,534	4,581	61%	\$251,085.82	128,498	\$ 1.95

CANADA	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alberta	110	52	47%	\$ 2,321.92	1,059	\$ 2.19
Atlantic Provinces:						
New Brunswick	31	21	68	945.34	445	2.12
Newfoundland	9	7	77	212.32	129	1.65
Nova Scotia	50	32	65	1,204.11	632	1.91
Prince Edward Island	13	9	69	428.74	233	1.84
British Columbia	166	91	55	4,751.33	2,029	2.34
Manitoba	61	36	59	2,256.92	1,193	1.89
N.W. Territories	3	1	33	10.00	15	.77
Ontario	356	214	60	9,419.94	4,809	1.96
Quebec	237	123	52	3,392.85	4,211	.81
Saskatchewan	107	57	53	2,161.64	1,111	1.95
Yukon Territory	3	2	67	40.00	62	.65
TOTAL for CANADA	1,146	645	56%	\$ 27,145.11	15,928	\$ 1.70
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	8,680	5,226	60%	\$278,230.93	144,426	\$ 1.93
FOREIGN						
Foreign	1,854			\$ 3,155.13	36,846	
Lone Member*					599	
World Hello				100.25		
Internationalists				778.16	332	
International Doctors	570			125.00		
Hospital Groups	570			1,169.29	10,764	
Prison Groups	648			236.77	25,000	
GRAND TOTAL	11,752			\$283,795.53	217,967	

*Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Provinces and Foreign Totals.

GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS COMPARISON -- 1963-64

	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
U.S.A. 1964	7,534	4,581	61%	\$251,085.82	128,498	\$ 1.95
U.S.A. 1963	7,033	4,283	61	240,837.95	122,483	1.97
Increase (Decrease)	501	298	(0%)	\$ 10,247.87	6,015	\$(.02)
Canada 1964	1,146	645	56%	\$ 27,145.11	15,928	\$ 1.70
Canada 1963	1,075	548	51	24,967.83	15,410	1.62
Increase (Decrease)	71	97	5%	\$ 2,177.28	518	\$.08
U.S.A. & Canada '64	8,680	5,226	60%	\$278,230.93	144,426	\$ 1.93
U.S.A. & Canada '63	8,108	4,831	60	265,805.78	137,893	1.93
Increase (Decrease)	572	395	(0%)	\$ 12,425.15	6,533	\$(.0)

1965 CONFERENCE MEMBERS*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

Bill Wilson -- Co-founder

G.S.B. TRUSTEES

NONALCOHOLIC

Dr. John L. Norris (Chairman)
Associate Medical Director
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, N. Y.

Dr. Travis E. Dancey
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada

Leonard V. Harrison
Box 383
Old Lyme, Conn.

Austin H. MacCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
New York, N.Y. 10016

Hon. John Murtagh
Administrative Judge
Criminal Court of the City of New York
100 Center Street
New York, N.Y. 10013

Archibald B. Roosevelt (Treasurer)
Roosevelt & Cross
40 Wall Street
New York, N.Y.

Bernard B. Smith (Vice-Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York, N.Y. 10022

Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
215 Milbank Avenue
Greenwich, Conn.

Prof. Harrison M. Trice
School of Industrial and Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, N.Y.

L. Ivan Underwood (Retired April 26, '65)
Purchase Lane
Rye, N.Y.

Dr. Vincent Dole (Elected April 26, '65)
Rockefeller Institute Hospital
New York, N.Y.

A.A. Trustees elected April G.S.B.
Meeting:
R. Fay Brown, N. Dakota
Frank Russell, Mass.
Tom Breen, Manitoba

ALCOHOLIC

*David Bancroft
755 Gratton Street
Ville St. Laurent
Montreal, Quebec, Canada

Mary Bernson
428 Quaker Road
Chappaqua, New York

Don Goddard
Choate Lane
Pleasantville, New York

Eugene S. Kelley (Secretary)
565 Fulton Ave.
Hempstead, N.Y.

D. Bruce Mansfield
Ohio Edison Co.
47 N. Main Street
Akron 8, Ohio

Jim Masterson
2525 Landwood Way
Carmichael, California

*Roy Scovil
827 N. E. 20th Street
Oklahoma City, Oklahoma

*Thomas A. Sharpe
P.O. Box 7356
Jacksonville, Florida

Murray Whitsett
53 Silvermine Road
New Canaan, Connecticut

*Term ended following
Conference.

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Tom White, Editor
Lee Beckwith
Mary Bernson
The Reverend Yvelin Gardner
Don Goddard
Jay Jacobs
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. (Treasurer)
Austin H. MacCormick

GRAPEVINE STAFF

Lee Beckwith
Paula Carpenter

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Herb Morse, Chairman
Eugene Kelley, 1st Vice-Chairman
Midge McFadden, 2nd Vice-Chairman
Murray Whitsett, Treasurer
Robert Hitchins
Richard Moulton
Fred Waters

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Herb Morse
Beth Kuhlman
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Hazel Rice

OTHERS ATTENDING CONFERENCE

G.S.O. DEPT. HEADS

Al Cryan
Kleina Jones
Dennis Manders
Maryann Turk
Nell Wing

CONSULTANTS

Ralph W. Bugli
(Public Information)
Wilbur A. Smith
(Ind. C.P.A.)

A.A. GRAPEVINE

Jack Morley
(Art Director)
Four Observers from the
Grapevine Editorial Board

*Members of Conference other than Area Delegates

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

APRIL 1965

Nonalcoholic Trustees (Class A)

John L. Norris, M.D. . . . is Chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. "Dr. Jack" is Associate Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, New York. . . Chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism. . . President of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests, he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

Travis Eugene Dancy, M.D. . . . Elected to the Board in January 1965. Dr. Dancy is Chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and Senior Psychiatrist at Montreal General Hospital. He has been a good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. Group in Quebec. Now he will be the first Class A Trustee to come from Canada to serve regularly.

Leonard V. Harrison. . . First came on the Board in 1941 and, with the exception of his resignation from October, 1950 to January, 1953, has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as Chairman of the General Service Board from April, 1956 to April, 1961. For many years he served as Director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

Austin H. MacCormick. . . Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become a Professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as Executive Director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a Director of the A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board.

John M. Murtagh. . . Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, is the Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York, a new court with 78 judges replacing Magistrates' Courts and Court of Special Sessions. Previously, he had been Chief Justice of the Court of Special Sessions, Chief City Magistrate, and Commissioner of Investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. The Judge has long

been a good friend of A.A. and comes to the Board with a sure understanding of the alcoholism illness.

Archibald B. Roosevelt (Treasurer of the General Service Board and Chairman of the Board's Finance & Budgetary Committee) . . . was elected to the General Service Board in January, 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs.

Bernard B. Smith. . . was elected to the General Service Board in June, 1944 and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January, 1951 to April, 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II, on her visit to the United States.

Harry M. Tiebout, M.D. . . . was elected to the Board in April, 1957. He was the first psychiatrist to recognize the work of Alcoholic Anonymous, and to use A.A. principles in his own practice. In the early days when A.A. was little known, he was instrumental in having Bill W. speak before the Neurology and Psychiatry section of the Medical Society of the State of New York, and the American Psychiatric Association. He has written many inspiring articles, among them, "The Ego Factors in the Surrender of Alcoholism."

Harrison M. Trice, Ph. D. . . . was elected to the General Service Board in January, 1957 and has served there, and as a member of the Literature Committee, with great enthusiasm. He is an Associate Professor in the School of Industrial Labor Relations at Cornell University. He has been a frequent contributor to professional journals, and a consultant to various study groups and to private companies on the subject of alcoholism.

L. Ivan Underwood. . . was elected to the Board in January, 1956. Before his retirement he headed up the export activities of Republic Steel Corporation, traveling a great deal and visiting A.A. overseas. He is chairman of the General Service Board Literature Committee.

A.A. Trustees (Class B)

David M. Bancroft. . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. He was nominated by the A.A. Groups in Quebec, Canada. He has had 19 years of continuous sobriety in A.A. and was the first Delegate to the General Service Conference from the Province of Quebec. He introduced A.A. to Montreal and subsequently to all of the Province of Quebec. He has his own business, a general accounting service.

Mary Bernson. . . was elected to the Board January, 1962. She has been an active member of the Chappaqua Group since March, 1954. She has served as Secretary, Program and Group Chairman, and has been a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board since March, 1961. Professionally, Mary has been a practicing lawyer in both New York City and Chappaqua since 1948.

Don Goddard. . . was elected to the General Service Board in July, 1961. He served as Editor of the A.A. Grapevine from 1955 to 1957 and is currently a Director of A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board. He joined A.A. in March, 1953 and is an active member of the Chappaqua, New York Group; also, he is a member of their Steering Committee. Professionally, he was employed as writer-editor for the News Department of the

New York World newspaper and published his own weekly paper in Homer, New York for approximately five years. Since that time, he has been writer, editor and commentator for various radio and television networks. He joined A.B.C. News Staff as broadcaster and editor in 1953 and is working there at present. The winner of the two Peabody Awards for news presentation, one of these awards was for production of "But for the Grace of God," a televised story of A.A., also "Medical Horizons." He has covered many of the big stories in the last half-dozen years for the network, including participation in two National Conventions.

Eugene S. Kelley. . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963. Had served as Director of A.A. World Services, Inc., since April, 1960. He has served on the Finance Committee of the General Service Board for two years. Has been an active member of the Manhattan Group of New York City since March, 1942. He served as President of New York Intergroup Association Steering Committee from January, 1955 to June, 1956. He has cooperated with the Medical Director of a large corporation in the formation of a policy and plan for the rehabilitation of their alcoholic employees. In non-A.A. life, he has been employed in Industrial Sales -- with the same company for 43 years.

D. Bruce Mansfield, . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1964, following nomination at a Conference electoral session where he was Ohio's candidate for the East Central Region. He is presently President of Ohio Edison Company, Akron, Ohio, with which he became associated as General Counsel in 1948. He has been an active member of Ohio Groups since 1945; his current Group is the King School Group of Akron.

James Masterson, . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, following nomination at electoral session of the General Service Conference where he was California's candidate for the Pacific Region. Has had over 12 years of continuous sobriety. Continuous activity in Northern California Conference Committee, serving his area as Alternate Delegate and Delegate. Is Motor Vehicle Representative and License Examiner for the Department of Motor Vehicles, Sacramento.

Roy Scovil, . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, following nomination at electoral session of General Service Conference where he was Oklahoma's candidate for the

Southwest Region. He has had 20 years of sobriety and did much of the early A.A. pioneering in Oklahoma. He was his state's first Delegate to the General Service Conference. Owns his own business dealing in builders specialties and hardware in Oklahoma City.

Thomas A. Sharpe, . . was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. He was nominated by the A.A. Groups in Florida. He has had 22 years of continuous sobriety in A.A. and was the first Florida A.A. member. He was also the North Florida Delegate to the General Service Conference in 1951 and 1952. He operates his own business, that of a manufacturer's agent.

Murray Whitsett, . . was elected to the Board in April 1964 following two years of service as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. He is presently Chairman of the Public Information Committee and a member of the sub-committee of the Finance Committee to study pension programs. Murray has 13 years in A.A., is a member of the New Canaan, Conn., Group. He is a newspaper advertising executive.

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(The International Committee is a subcommittee of the G.S.B. Policy Committee.)

GREAT RESPONSIBILITY

(Continued from page 9)

Recognizing this, the new Trustees' Plan provides that our friends would in the future act in a minority, thus becoming our associates. In making this humble offer, they have called upon us to assume the highest of responsibilities -- the guidance, under God, of our own life as a fellowship.

If this, then, is their demonstration of humility, what is going to be our demonstration of responsibility? As to a family just coming of age, they have in substance told us "The world of the future stretches before you, and you are well prepared. Go out into it, fearing nothing. Our faith in you is confident and strong. As you move onward toward your destiny, may you always remember that God in His wisdom has granted you three precious Graces: Freedom from a deadly affliction, a life experience that enables you to carry that priceless freedom to others, and a vision, ever widening, of God's reality and of His Love."

May we of Alcoholics Anonymous remain ever worthy of these three gifts of Grace and of the supreme responsibilities that are now ours, for so long as a bountiful God may wish A.A. to endure.

On Being Responsible

(Continued from page 10)

Dr. Norris recalled the writings of Jean Paul Sartre, the French existentialist. Sartre, he said, has a concept of each human being acting "as though the whole human race had its eye fixed on what each man is doing, and regulating his conduct accordingly."

Every man, Dr. Norris said, ought to ask himself: "Am I really a man who has the right to act in such a manner that humanity will want to regulate itself by what I do?"

He concluded: "You folks in A.A. who really have this right are doing a job that is being looked at by our society. The changes that have come about in relation to alcoholism and in the relationships between people, as a result of A.A. are more far-reaching than any of us dream. This is an exciting thing. It is a responsible thing. And how much meaning and point and joy it gives to the lives of all of us."

ROSTER

1965 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N. W. FLORIDA	(15) Jim Hawkins, 2505 22 Street, Bessemer, Alabama	IOWA	(15) Thomas Pickens, 500 Polk Blvd. Des Moines, Iowa
ALASKA	(14) Claude Millsap, P. O. Box 1405, Juneau, Alaska	KANSAS	(14) F. Sharon Foster, Box 46, Ellsworth, Kansas
ARIZONA	(14) Leo Rayburn, 4619 North 54 Avenue, Phoenix, Arizona	KENTUCKY	(14) Hugh Alderson, 1744 Harrison Street, Paducah, Kentucky
ARKANSAS	(15) Hollis Akins, P. O. Box 222, Dumas, Arkansas	LOUISIANA	(15) Maurice Reilly, Jr., 5407 Prytania Street, New Orleans, Louisiana
CALIFORNIA	(15) Southern - Harry Hallock, 1400 Fairfield Street, Glendale, California	MAINE	(14) Kenneth Sanders, 6 Verdun Street, Fairfield, Maine
	(15) Northern Coastal - Ed Hartsock, P. O. Box 463, Pittsburg, California	MARYLAND	(14) L. Milton Hause, 2926 Hiss Avenue, Parkville, Maryland
	(14) Northern Interior - H. K. (Rickey) Schreiber, Box 342, Central Valley, California	MASSACHUSETTS	(15) Eastern - Bill Coogan, 40 Court Street, Boston, Massachusetts
	(14) San Diego - Frank Surman, 4475 Granger Street, San Diego 7, California		(14) Western - Leo H. Burns, 76 Byers Street, Springfield, Massachusetts
	(14) Southern Coastal - Tom M. Allen, 25532 Pacific Avenue, San Bernardino, California	MICHIGAN	(15) Southeast - Everett P. (Scotty) Sewell, 6852 Longworth, Waterford, Michigan
COLORADO	(15) Jack Mohr, 755 Holly Street, Denver, Colorado		(15) Central - Ralph McPherson, Box 162, Whitmore Lake, Michigan
CONNECTICUT	(15) Mrs. Cora "Tommy" Dayton, 39 Williams Road, Cheshire, Connecticut		(14) Western - Edwin Laubenthal, 933 Kenneth, S.W., Grand Rapids, Michigan
DELAWARE	(14) Richard (Dick) Boyce, 60 Lambert Drive, Dover, Delaware	MINNESOTA	(14) Northern - Donald Formo, 127 East Summit, Fergus Falls, Minnesota
D.C.	(15) Hal Potter, 10207 Calumet Drive, Silver Springs, Maryland		(15) Southern - Robert Daly, 5154th Avenue, S.W., Rochester, Minnesota
FLORIDA	(15) Northern - Bert Lynch, 1204 East Silver Springs Blvd., Ocala, Florida	MISSISSIPPI	(14) Bish Mathis, P. O. Drawer "D", Pass Christian, Mississippi
	(15) Southern - Walter Thompson, 2848 Northwest Tenth Avenue, Fort Lauderdale, Florida	MISSOURI	(15) Eastern - Jim Barber, 4220 Sweet Gum Drive, St. Louis, Missouri
GEORGIA	(14) Heflin Daniel, 188 Temple Avenue, Newnan, Georgia		(15) Western - Keet Rader, Branson, Missouri
HAWAII	(15) Butch Cline, 47-339 Juloni Street, Kaneohe, Hawaii	MONTANA	(14) Judy Machler, Box 88, Lewistown, Montana
IDAHO	(14) Arnold Teeple, 519 N. 11 Avenue, Pocatello, Idaho	NEBRASKA	(14) Don Marquard, 640 East Memorial Drive, Grand Island, Nebraska
ILLINOIS	(15) Chicago - James T. Griffin, Jr., 1569 N. Green Bay Road, Lake Forest, Illinois	NEVADA	(15) Ray Free, P. O. Box 878, Carson City, Nevada
	(14) Northern - R. Bruce Wight, 204 North West Street, Waukegan, Illinois	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(14) *Jack Kirk, R.F.D. 3, Laconia, New Hampshire
	(15) Southern - Wes James, 1608 Whittier Avenue, Springfield, Illinois	NEW JERSEY	(15) Northern - George Dvorak, 371 Pine Avenue, Manasquan, New Jersey
INDIANA	(15) Ross Stanton, 6225 Birch Avenue, Gary, Indiana		(14) Southern - Ruth L. Day, 600 South White Horse Pike, Audubon, New Jersey
		NEW MEXICO	(14) Darrell McCleskey, P. O. Box 880, Los Alamos, New Mexico

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	(14) Mohawk-Hudson-Berkshire - Frank Hogan, 1541 Barclay Place, Schenectady, New York	VIRGINIA	(15) Earl Felton, 1223 Duke Street, Portsmouth, Virginia
	(15) Southeastern - Frank Chase, 1213 East 88 Street, Brooklyn 36, New York	WASHINGTON	(15) Ed Myers, 663 North Rochester, Tacoma, Washington
	(14) Western - George J. Schnatz, 41 Byron Avenue, Kenmore, New York	WEST VIRGINIA	(15) Jack McCarthy, 1027 Ann Street, Parkersburg, West Virginia
NORTH CAROLINA	(15) Harry Barrett, 701 Museum Drive, Charlotte, North Carolina	WISCONSIN	(14) N. Wisc. & Upper Mich. - Robert Zeugner, 1507 Tenth Avenue, Green Bay, Wisconsin
NORTH DAKOTA	(14) Gordon LaMont, 1513 North Third Street, Fargo, North Dakota		(15) Southern - Clarence Topel, 8321-47th Avenue, Kenosha, Wisconsin
OHIO	(15) Central & S.E. - Harold Hayhurst, 291 Columbian Avenue, Columbus, Ohio	WYOMING	(14) David Thompson, Box 1163, Cody, Wyoming
	(15) Northeast - Charles Gresser, 721 Fairlane Avenue, Canton 10, Ohio	PUERTO RICO	(14) Charlie Carballo, 306 Lerida Street, Urb. Valencia, Rio Piedras, Puerto Rico
	(14) N.W. Ohio & S.E. Michigan - Ray Haneline, 1019 Keeler, Maumee, Ohio		
	(14) S. Southwest - Harold Stump, 1715 S. Derexa Street, Hamilton, Ohio		
OKLAHOMA	(15) Mike Rainbolt, P. O. Box 248, Cordell, Oklahoma		
OREGON	(14) Bill Griffith, 17507 S. E. Rothe Place, Portland 22, Oregon		
PENNSYLVANIA	(15) Eastern - Gail Sartorelli, 27 Braxton Road, Rosemont, Pennsylvania		
	(15) Western - Ray Murphy, 482 Jefferson Street, Meadville, Pennsylvania		
RHODE ISLAND	(14) Fred Watson, 319 Broadway, Newport, Rhode Island		
SOUTH CAROLINA	(14) Ceth Mason, 188 King Street, Charleston, South Carolina		
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TENNESSEE	(14) Wayne Reed, 1110 Bluebird, Memphis, Tennessee		
TEXAS	(15) Northeast - Morris McFarland, 416 South College, Tyler, Texas		
	(14) Northwest - Ralph Gordon, 3317 Fleetwood, Amarillo, Texas		
	(15) Southeast - Jerry Wilson, P. O. Box 66416, Houston, Texas		
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UTAH	(15) Ralph Searle, 3601 Monroe Blvd., Ogden, Utah		

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ATLANTIC PROVINCES	(14) New Brunswick & Prince Edward Island - Bob Clayton, 85 Ludlow Street West, St. John, New Brunswick, Canada
	(15) Nova Scotia and Newfoundland - Bob Pritchard, 51 Prince of Wales Street, St. John's, Newfoundland, Canada
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MANITOBA	(14) Ross Marr, 1090 McMillan Avenue, Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada
ONTARIO	(15) Eastern - Alf McGowan, 86 5th Street, Ottawa, Ontario, Canada
	(14) Western - Cliff Morris, 8 Thorndale Crescent, Hamilton, Ont., Canada
	(15) N. Northwestern - Garfield Kyer, 4 Janmar Court, Sudbury, Ontario, Canada
QUEBEC	(14) Bill Burns, 502 Cardinal Street, Ville St. Laurent, Montreal, Que., Canada (English)
	(14) Robert Roy, 7535 Sagard Street, Montreal, Que., Canada (French)
SASKATCHEWAN	(14) John Tkachuk, 16 Newlands Street, Regina, Saskatchewan, Canada

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